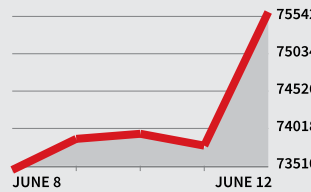


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 75527.95 (+1695.40)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23622.90	+461.30
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.41	+0.45
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.11	-0.65
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147208.00	+3006
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	242582.00	+9991

SAFER TOMORROW.

DoT clears spectrum hurdles for vehicle safety technology, paves way for V2V and C-V2X systems to enhance road safety **p2**



AUTO FOCUS.

Updated Honda City e: HEV blends efficiency, comfort and reliability and hybrid appeal **p4**

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QUICKLY.

INDIAN SAILORS AT RISK
Delhi protests US strikes on vessels in Gulf of Oman



New Delhi: India summoned US Chargé d’Affaires Jason Meeks on Friday, the second time in three days, and lodged a “strong protest” against the attacks by US forces on commercial vessels with Indian mariners in the Gulf of Oman, which resulted in the loss of three lives. “The Ministry again conveyed its concern over the use of deadly force against civilian shipping. Such actions are unacceptable and undermine the safety, security and stability of maritime commerce in a sensitive region at a difficult time,” the MEA said. **p3**

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Pricey food, fuel push May retail inflation to 16-month high of 3.93%

HEADWINDS. More pressure seen on geopolitical tensions, monsoon uncertainties

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Retail inflation rose to a 16-month high of 3.93 per cent in May, up from 3.48 per cent in April, fuelled by rising food, energy, and precious metal costs.

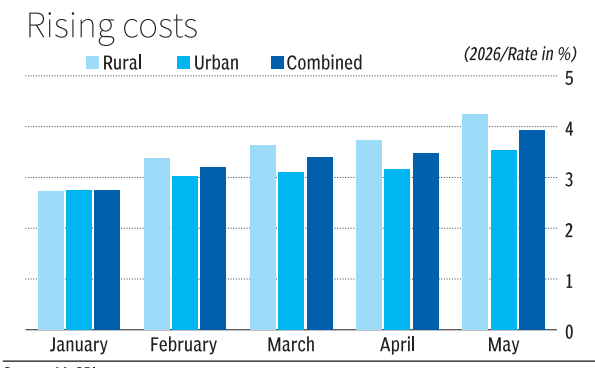
Government data released on Friday revealed a steep 43 per cent increase in the headline rate over the last five months.

Though still marginally below the central bank’s 4 per cent medium-term target, analysts anticipate upward pressure ahead due to below-normal monsoon projections and continuing turmoil in West Asia.

KEY DRIVERS

Precious metal jewellery, tomato, ginger, raisin (kishmish) and monacca were the five items with the highest inflation. On the other hand, potato, peas, motor car and jeep, cumin (jeera) and motorcycle and scooter were the top five items with lowest inflation at the all-India combined level in May.

According to economists, the May print was lower than expected. “While CPI infla-



Source: MoSPI

tion came in lower than expected, it rose to its highest level in 16 months. A sharp increase in transport inflation and higher food inflation were the primary drivers of headline inflation during the month. ‘Food and beverage’ inflation increased as the favourable base effect from last year waned and also due to a seasonal up-tick,” said Rajni Sinha, Chief Economist with CareEdge.

Heatwaves across several regions also adversely impacted the supply of several food items, pushing up the inflationary pressures, she added.

Debobam Chaudhuri, Chief Economist at Piramal Group, said retail consumers

remained largely insulated in May from the sharp rise in wholesale inflation, particularly across petrochemicals and hydrocarbon-linked products. “However, categories such as restaurants, cooking fuel and transportation are already witnessing a sequential pick-up in price pressures,” he said.

PRICE PRESSURES

According to Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at Bank of Baroda, inflation is expected to move higher in the coming months, depending on the transmission of higher energy prices across different products. The monsoon impact will be reflected in food product

prices. “The monsoon is already delayed, and advice given to farmers was to wait for the rain to arrive before sowing,” he said.

Megha Arora, Director at India Ratings and Research, said the headline inflation is likely to rise further to 4.5 per cent in June, surpassing the RBI’s comfort level of 4 per cent, but will remain within its upper tolerance band of 6 per cent. “Geopolitical tensions and El Nino conditions continue to remain the upside risks to inflation,” she said.

REPO HIKE COMING

Market anticipation is that the central bank will hike the policy repo rate during its October review. “The sub-4 per cent headline and core inflation point towards comfortable trends in the near term. While softening crude oil prices and the cap on the weakening rupee remain a tailwind, we continue to monitor the impact of adverse monsoon on food inflation. For now, we continue to expect 50 bps rate hike beginning October,” said Upasna Bhardwaj, Chief Economist, Kotak Mahindra Bank.

Markets clock biggest 2-month gain as oil eases on US-Iran truce plan

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Hopes of a US-Iran truce and expectations of a broader peace deal, combined with softer crude prices, fuelled a rally in the equity market, marking the highest single-day gain in two months. A significant driver of the rally was aggressive short-covering as traders rushed to unwind bearish bets in the face of rising prices.

The BSE SENSEX jumped 1,695.40 points, or 2.30 per cent, to close at 75,527.95, while the Nifty rose 461.30 points, or 1.99 per cent, settling comfortably above the 23,600 mark at 23,622.90.

Friday’s rise led to a surge in investor wealth, with the overall market capitalisation (m-cap) of BSE-listed companies increasing by ₹9.7-lakh crore in a single session, aggregating to ₹461.5 lakh crore.

CRUDE, THE KEY

“The sharp pullback in crude oil and indications from Iran that tensions may cool fuelled the market rally,” said Pratik Gupta, CEO and Co-head, Kotak Institutional Equities. “Crude oil price is the real barometer, and its decline has reassured investors more than political rhetoric,” he added.

Deal hopes fuel rally

	Close	% gain
Sensex	75,527.95	2.30
Nifty50	23,622.90	1.99
Nifty Next50	70,007.20	2.38
Nifty Bank	56,814.80	2.97
Nifty Midcap100	60,768.10	2.43
Nifty Smallcap100	18,197.45	2.80

Crude oil slipped to a three-month low of \$88 per barrel. This also helped the rupee appreciate, and it ended at a one-week high of ₹95.11 against the US dollar.

“Normalisation of energy flows takes away one of India’s biggest macro risks. Softer crude eases the trade deficit, supports the rupee, reduces the inflation risk, and lifts the overall market sentiment,” said Anand Shah, CIO, PMS & AIF, ICICI Prudential AMC.

He added that while this improves the backdrop for risk assets, a sustained pickup in FII inflows will likely hinge on a stronger recovery in growth and corporate earnings, which may take time to materialise.

While Friday’s development is positive, it is not a runaway trigger for Indian equities, said the CEO of a domestic brokerage firm.

“Since we didn’t correct much earlier, the upside may be measured. It mainly removes a key downside risk, oil, currency pressure, and inflation, but factors like monsoon uncertainty and AI-led disruption in IT hiring still cap aggressive upside.”

STRONG RISK APPETITE

The broader market outperformed frontline indices, indicating a strong risk appetite among investors. The Nifty Midcap 100 rose 2.43 per cent, while the Nifty Smallcap 100 advanced 2.8 per cent, reflecting widespread participation beyond blue-chips. Sectoral performance remained broadly positive, with all major indices closing in the green. The rally was led by Nifty Realty, Financial Services, PSU Banks, Private Banks and Consumer Durables gaining between 2 and 4 per cent.

SpaceX makes strong Nasdaq debut after record IPO

Reuters

SpaceX rose 11 per cent in its Nasdaq debut on Friday, lifting its valuation to about \$1.96 trillion as investors piled into the world’s largest Initial Public Offering (IPO) and bought onto Elon Musk’s sprawling empire spanning rockets, satellite communications and AI.

The stock opened for trading at \$150 compared with the IPO price of \$135 per share.

The deal was being closely scrutinised because of the stakes for the IPO market, which some bankers said could face difficulties if SpaceX shares close below Thursday’s pricing level.

BIG IPOs COMING

With SpaceX widely viewed as a dress rehearsal for a new generation of mega-listings, market participants were also watching for signals on in-



Elon Musk, Founder, SpaceX, speaks via videolink on Friday at the Nasdaq MarketSite

vestor appetite ahead of forthcoming IPOs for AI heavyweights Anthropic and OpenAI.

FIRST TRILLIONAIRE

The stock’s performance will also be a test for the so-called “Musk premium,” which has been the force behind Tesla’s \$1 trillion-plus valuation, despite coming under pressure during Musk’s active role in President Donald Trump’s administration. The landmark listing ce-

mented Musk’s status as the first trillionaire ever and propelled SpaceX into the ranks of the world’s most valuable companies even though the firm posted a loss of nearly \$5 billion last year and generated only a fraction of the revenue brought in by similarly valued tech giants.

“I gave SpaceX a 10 per cent chance of succeeding at all,” Musk said in Texas, shortly before the opening bell.

SpaceX President Gwynne Shotwell and Chief Financial Officer Bret Johnsen rang the Nasdaq opening bell at 9.30 am ET (1330GMT).

WORLD’S LARGEST IPO

The record IPO is a culmination of Musk’s long-held ambitions in space and technology and has stood out for rewriting Wall Street’s IPO playbook and drawing legions of retail investors into the market.

At \$75 billion, the deal’s

proceeds were more than double those of Saudi Aramco’s record-setting 2019 IPO.

The valuation could rise further should underwriters exercise their right to sell additional shares, a decision typically made within 30 days after the offering.

NASDAQ 100 ENTRY

Although SpaceX may have to wait for entry into the S&P 500, its expected fast-track inclusion in the Nasdaq 100 will soon make it a major holding for passive funds and ETFs that track the index, creating a fresh source of demand for its shares.

For all the excitement surrounding the IPO, determining what SpaceX is actually worth remains a difficult valuation exercise.

SpaceX said its market opportunity spans \$28.5 trillion, a figure it called the largest in human history.

STILL IN THE DARK



MOTHER’S GRIEF. Sita Patni mourns in front of portraits of her son Akash, 14, who died in the Air India Boeing 787-8 Dreamliner crash on June 12, 2025, in Ahmedabad, on the first anniversary of the mishap. Victims’ families are still in the dark about the cause of the crash with the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau yet to come up with its final report. **(Reports on p10)** REUTERS

Govt caps diesel sale at retail pumps to 200 litres per customer per day to curb black marketing

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

In a significant development to curb black marketing and hoarding, the government has said a retail fuel outlet can sell only up to 200 litres of diesel per person per day.

Also, industrial and commercial users, or bulk buyers, cannot purchase petrol and diesel from retail outlets.

The current situation is one of uneven, extraordinary demand growth in some retail outlets, driven by the shifting of bulk diesel volumes to PSU oil marketing companies’ retail outlets.

MISUSE BY BULK USERS

This is driven by industrial and direct (institutional and commercial) consumers, who have been shifting their procurement from dedicated pumps to retail outlets due to the difference between bulk and retail diesel prices.



Uneven demand growth at select outlets is being driven by bulk diesel volumes shifting to PSU-run fuel stations

This has resulted in petrol bunks in several parts of the country, specifically in Maharashtra and parts of Punjab and Gujarat, reporting fuel shortages and long queues. The other reason is that private oil marketing companies reported a decline of around 58 per cent in diesel sales during May due to higher prices, the Oil Ministry said in a statement.

The data for May compared with the corresponding month last year reveal a

significant surge in diesel sales through Oil marketing companies’ (OMCs) retail outlets, with 327 districts recording more than 10 per cent growth, and 80 districts exceeding 30 per cent.

“Institutional and direct or industrial and commercial customers shall not procure or cause to be procured MS and/or HSD from retail outlets and shall only source their MS/HSD requirements from their own consumer pumps. Retail outlet dealers shall dispense HSD only in a vehicle tank or PESO-approved containers, and not exceeding 200 litres in a day to a customer/vehicle, and this HSD cannot be resold,” said a government notification.

OMCs and retail outlet dealers shall ensure compliance with the restrictions and prevent their circumvention. Any order issued under this provision can only be for an initial validity

period not exceeding 90 days from the date of issue or till revoked by another order, whichever is earlier, it added.

Blatant instances of procurement of large quantities of diesel in jerry cans and reselling them have come to the government’s notice. This order will enable strict action against such buyers/operators, dealers and officers involved.

In directions to the States and Union Territories, the Ministry said they shall take all measures to implement this order, including action against hoarding, black marketing, unauthorised procurement, diversion and other malpractices relating to Motor Spirit and High-Speed Diesel under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955, the Motor Spirit and High Speed Diesel (Regulation of Supply, Distribution and Prevention of Malpractices) Order, 2005 and other applicable laws.

IIT-M releases world’s first 3D brainstem atlas

From prenatal period to adulthood, it’s the most comprehensive mapping of the brain

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

In a first, the Sudha Gopalakrishnan Brain Centre (SGBC) at the Indian Institute of Technology, Madras, has released the most detailed 3D Atlas (a collection of images) of the human brainstem, thanks to its high throughput brain imaging and computing platform.

3D RECONSTRUCTION

Called ‘Anchor’, an acronym for Atlas of Neurochemical Characterisation of the human brainstem with 3D Reconstruction, it comprises the most comprehensive, multi-modal, 3D maps of the human brainstem to date, spanning from the prenatal period to childhood and adult brains.

While currently brain imaging is only possible at a resolution level provided by



The ‘Anchor’ human brainstem atlas being released during the 3rd BRICS Neuroscience Symposium 2026 on Friday

an MRI or a CT scan, ‘Anchor’ provides a cellular level resolution of the hundreds of nuclei that make up a brainstem. The IIT-M team has also made ‘Anchor’ publicly available through a website to ensure that the research benefits researchers, clinicians and patients around the world.

BEYOND MRI, CT

SGBC Head Mohanasankar Sivaprakasam told *businessline* that this is the first time that a detailed human brain-

stem map has been created by imaging brainstems at different points in human life.

Currently, if one wants to understand the brainstem, one can only look at it from an MRI or a CT and that’s essentially at a millimetre level resolution, but the brainstem is made of hundreds of nuclei and they are at a micron level, he explained.

“It is not only a scientific accomplishment, but also something that the medi-

cine/clinical field will hugely benefit from,” he added.

THE PROCESS

The process involved taking the brainstem, slicing it into 10 to 20 micron thins (a micron is one-fifth a human hair in fineness), and then putting the slices through a series of chemical and biological processes. These are then mapped and annotated digitally and aligned to recreate the brainstem with high-performance computing and advanced AI imaging tools.

Sivaprakasam said the SGBC is on a path to map over 100 whole brains across the human lifespan and neurological diseases over the next two years.

SGBC is funded through seed contributions by Infosys Co-founder Kris Gopalakrishnan, private firms and philanthropic arms.

QUICKLY.

Amazon banks on its own charging infra to expand



New Delhi/London: Amazon is relying on on-site charging infrastructure for its growing fleet of electric delivery vehicles in India, while also working with partners to expand charging and transportation options as it pushes towards its sustainability goals. The US-based e-commerce giant already has plans to introduce over 1,000 electric trucks into its operations in India over the next five years, joining the existing 10,000 electric vehicles fleet. The move is aimed at delivering packages from Amazon fulfilment centres more sustainably. Replying to questions on the limited availability of public EV charging infrastructure in India, Andreas Marschner, Amazon Vice-President, Global Engineering and Sustainability, said the challenge is not unique to India and exists across markets globally. [PTI](#)

DoT clears spectrum hurdles for vehicle safety technology

SAFETY FIRST. Paves ways for installation of V2V, C-V2X systems to minimise accidents

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has issued two notifications within a day of each other, de-licensing spectrum bands for automotive radar and vehicle-to-everything (V2X or V2I) communication, clearing the regulatory path for next-generation road safety technology in India.

However, telecom operators, including Reliance Jio, Bharti Airtel and Vodafone-Idea, had opposed separate service authorisation for vehicle-to-infrastructure (V2I) or vehicle-to-vehicle (V2V) communications, particularly where such communication could be enabled through existing licensed telecom networks (through cellular networks or through localised roadside infrastructure deployed for intelligent transport and road-safety applications).



ON THE MOVE. The DoT's notifications will usher in next-generation road safety technology in the country

The first notification exempts short-range automotive radar systems operating in the 77-81 GHz band from licensing requirements.

CRUISE CONTROL These radar units are the sensors behind increasingly common Advanced Driver Assistance Systems features, such as collision avoidance, blind-spot monitoring, adaptive cruise control and automated parking, by bouncing radio waves off nearby objects to detect their dis-

tance, speed and position.

"A short-range automotive radar system installed on a vehicle and operating in the 77-81 GHz frequency band, shall be permitted without assignment of radio frequency on non-interference, non-protection and non-exclusive basis; no licence shall be required for possession of such short-range automotive radar system by any person or its sale or hire by any dealer," said the DoT through a Gazette notification on Friday. Under the

new rules, manufacturers, dealers and vehicle owners will no longer need individual spectrum licences to install, sell or possess such systems, provided the equipment meets specified technical limits, a maximum average power of 50 dBm (decibel-milliwatts) and peak power of 55 dBm EIRP within a 4 GHz emission bandwidth.

REAL-TIME DATA

The DoT issued a parallel notification for on-board units enabling Cellular Vehicle-to-Everything (C-V2X) communication in the 5875-5905 MHz band (or 5.875-5.925 GHz band), where the radar gives a vehicle the ability to sense its immediate surroundings.

This technology allows it to communicate by sharing real-time data on speed, position, direction and road conditions with other vehicles, traffic signals and broader network infrastructure.

Tata Sons board approves annual accounts for FY26

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The board of Tata Sons, which met on Friday, approved the annual accounts for FY26 and discussed the broad operating agenda for the current financial year, according to sources familiar with the developments.

The holding company of the Tata conglomerate is understood to have reported a net profit slightly higher than in FY25, said sources

privity to information. In FY25 it had reported a standalone net profit of ₹26,232 crore and consolidated profit of ₹28,898.5 crore.

Apart from approving the annual financial statements, the board is understood to have reviewed the group's operating priorities and outlined plans for the year ahead. The board has also recommended a dividend, which sources said, is likely to be on the same level as last year. In FY25, it paid out dividend at the rate of ₹64,900

per share, involving an outgo of ₹2,623 crore.

There was no response to the e-mails sent to the office of Noel Tata or Tata Sons seeking confirmation. The meeting comes at a time when several Tata Group companies are pursuing large investment programmes across sectors, ranging from aviation and semi-conductors to digital businesses.

Sources said that none of the issues that have generated considerable discus-

sions in recent months — such as a possible third term for N Chandrasekaran as Chairman, changes to the composition of the Tata Sons board, or the potential listing of Tata Sons — were part of the formal agenda.

TATA SONS LISTING

However, people aware of the discussions said the issue of the listing of Tata Sons was briefly touched upon by board members. The issue has remained in focus since the Reserve Bank of India has

continued to classify Tata Sons as an upper-layer non-banking financial company.

Earlier this month, the RBI Governor said that an updated list for upper layer NBFCs would be released shortly, though there was no clarity whether Tata Sons would still be part of it.

The meeting was attended by Tata Sons Chairman Chandrasekaran and other Directors, including Venu Srinivasan, Harish Manwani, and Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata.

Parle reverses no-return policy on expired products after ₹100 crore stock build-up

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Parle Biscuits Pvt Ltd has begun taking back expired products in select markets, and is developing a broader return mechanism, according to industry representatives.

This comes after distributor bodies flagged nearly ₹100 crore worth of damaged and expired inventory and heightened scrutiny from the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) and State food safety regulators.

A MAJOR SHIFT

After years of resisting blanket expiry returns, Parle's move marks a significant shift for India's largest biscuit maker, which sells more than 100 crore biscuit packs a month.

The shift follows mounting pressure from distributors and a broader tightening of food-safety oversight across India's FMCG sector. In recent weeks, the FSSAI sought explanations from Nestlé India following reports of worm infestation in a batch of products, an episode that rattled investors



and highlighted the reputational risks associated with food-safety lapses.

At the same time, Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration Commissioner Tukaram Mundhe has intensified enforcement against spurious, adulterated and non-compliant products through inspections and raids.

Industry executives say the heightened scrutiny is prompting manufacturers to strengthen systems for recalls, expired stock collection and scientific disposal.

"We have heard that Parle is developing a policy for expired product returns. We have not received any formal communication yet, but expired products are being taken back in certain pockets of Maharashtra, Karnataka

and Kerala. It appears the company is moving towards a more structured mechanism," said Dhairiyashil Patil, President of the All India Consumer Products Distributors Federation (AICPDF).

Patil said stricter enforcement is increasing pressure on manufacturers to ensure that expired goods do not remain stranded in warehouses or find their way back into retail channels.

"A strict regulator changes the compliance environment. If inspectors find large volumes of expired food products sitting in warehouses waiting for disposal or credit notes, authorities can hold stakeholders accountable and ensure those goods are destroyed rather than re-entering the market," he said.

The significance of any policy change is magnified by the company's sheer size. Parle Biscuits, maker of Parle-G, reported standalone revenue of ₹15,568 crore in FY25 and group revenue of more than ₹17,500 crore. Industry estimates suggest it sells over 100 crore biscuit packs a month, produces more than 10 lakh tonnes annually and commands roughly 38-40 per

cent of India's organised biscuit market by volume.

For a company of that scale, even a small proportion of expired products remaining in the supply chain can become a significant food-safety issue, said industry executives.

DISPUTED INVENTORY

AICPDF claims nearly ₹100 crore worth of damaged and expired Parle inventory remains unresolved across distributor and retailer networks, largely comprising chocolates, confectionery, chips and namkeen products.

While the disputed inventory amounts to less than 1 per cent of Parle's FY25 revenue, distributors argue the issue has wider consumer-safety implications because expired food products must be traced, withdrawn and scientifically destroyed before they can re-enter retail channels.

The federation says products consumed widely by children, including chocolates, confectionery and packaged snacks, should be systematically collected and destroyed to eliminate the risk of their re-entering the market.

Ultraviolette eyes five-fold growth in export business

Our Bureau
Chennai

Electric two-wheeler maker Ultraviolette is expecting a 5X growth in exports this financial year as the company ramps up overseas operations.

Niraj Rajmohan, CTO & Co-founder, Ultraviolette, said exports accounted for about 10 per cent of the company's business in FY26. "Last year, we were still at a pilot stage in terms of exports and we only went live in August. This year, we will see a lot more growth," he said during the launch of a new dealership in Chennai on Friday.

The company currently exports to about 19 markets predominantly in Western Europe, including Italy, France, Germany, Spain, Netherlands and the UK. It is also planning pilot launches in Latin America and South-East Asia. He did not disclose the export revenue. The prices vary in such export markets due to duties and importer/distributor margins.

DEMAND FOR EVs

On the domestic market, he

VISUALLY.

Compiled by [Yashaswani Chauhan](#) | Graphic: [Visveswaran V](#)

Child labour's long road to zero

Observed every year on 12 June, World Day Against Child Labour draws attention to the millions of children still engaged in work instead of education. In 2024, 137.6 million children worldwide were engaged in child labour, including 54 million in hazardous work. In India, home to more than 10 million child labourers, over 40,000 were rescued from labour, sexual exploitation and begging in 2024-25



Over 137 million children remain trapped in labour worldwide

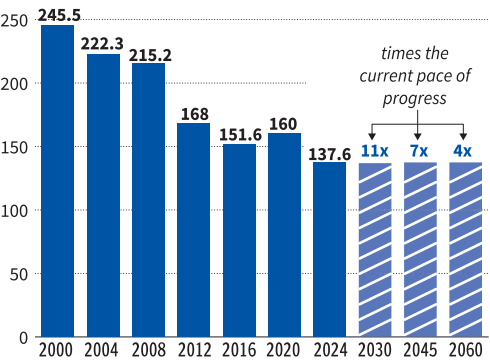
Global child labour situation (2024)

137.6 million
Children in child labour

54 million
Children in hazardous work

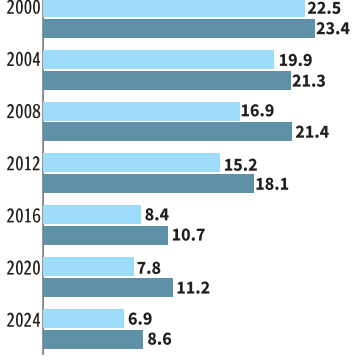
At today's pace, ending child labour could take decades

Children in child labour globally and acceleration needed to eliminate it
Number of children (in million)



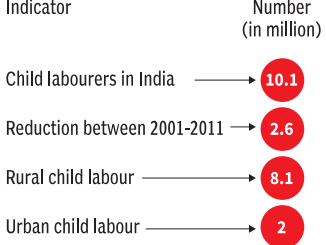
Girl child labour rates have fallen faster than boys globally

Share of children aged 5-17 in child labour (%)



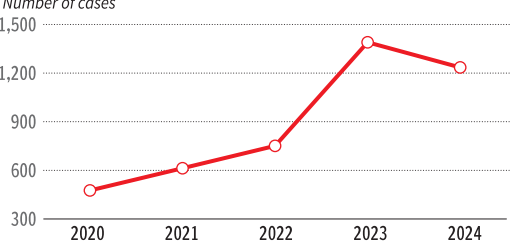
India still accounts for more than 10 million child labourers

Child labour in India (as per 2011 census)



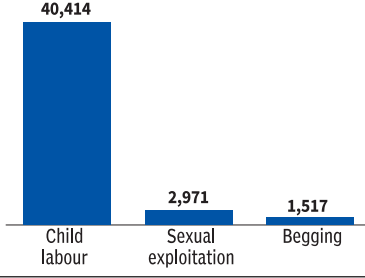
Child labour cases registered in India rose 159% between 2020 and 2024

Cases registered under the Child Labour Act



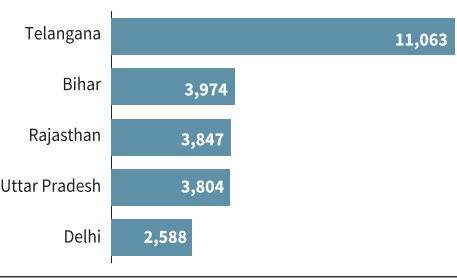
Over 90% of rescued children were found in child labour situations

Children rescued in India (2024-25)



Telangana accounted for over 11,000 child labour rescues

States with highest child labour rescues (2024-25)



Source: International Labour Organisation, Building the case for zero report by India Child Protection

Hitachi Energy to set up ₹2,000 cr transformer plant in Gujarat

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Hitachi Energy India will invest around ₹2,000 crore to set up a large power transformer manufacturing facility at Karjan in Vadodara, marking one of the biggest investments in India's power

equipment sector. The new plant, scheduled to be operational by FY28, is expected to manufacture a significant volume of large power transformers annually and support applications ranging from high-voltage transmission corridors and HVDC projects to AI data centres, power generation facilities and large industrial installations.

LOCAL PRODUCTION

Hitachi Energy said the new factory will strengthen domestic manufacturing capabilities amid rising demand for transformers, driven by grid expansion, industrial electrification, renewable energy integration and the rapid growth of data centres.

"This investment reflects our confidence in India's energy future and the country's growing stature as a strategic manufacturing base. By expanding our manufacturing presence, we aim to empower local communities, create skilled jobs and deliver innovative solutions that support the country's energy and sustainability goals," said N Venu, Managing Director and CEO, Hitachi Energy India.

The facility will complement the company's existing transformer manufacturing footprint in Gujarat, which includes power, dry distribution and traction transformer factories, as well as transformer insulation and component manufacturing

facilities at Mysore and Halol.

The company said the factory will be developed as a fully digital manufacturing facility, integrating smart manufacturing technologies and end-to-end digital connectivity, to improve productivity, quality control and operational efficiency.

The plant is also being designed as a LEED-certified facility with a focus on energy efficiency, responsible resource utilisation and reduced environmental impact.

It will incorporate advanced manufacturing technologies, alongside stringent health, safety and sustainability standards.

"This new factory will

strengthen our ability to serve customers locally while contributing to India's self-reliance and infrastructure development," said Bruno Melles, CEO of Hitachi Energy's Transformers Business Unit.

JOB CREATION

The project is expected to generate more than 1,000 direct and indirect jobs and boost local supplier ecosystems in Gujarat.

The investment forms part of Hitachi Energy's global capacity expansion programme covering manufacturing, engineering, research and development and strategic partnerships to meet growing demand for electricity worldwide.

Meesho to acquire Kirana Club, its Indian arm for ₹202 crore

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

E-commerce marketplace Meesho is set to acquire Kirana Club and its Indian subsidiary Retail Pulse Labs in a ₹202 crore transaction, marking a strategic push to strengthen its presence among small retailers and deepen its footprint in India's commerce ecosystem.

The company informed the stock exchanges that its board had approved the acquisition of 100 per cent of the share capital of Singapore-incorporated Kirana Club and 0.41 per cent stake in Retail Pulse Labs Private

Ltd, for an aggregate consideration of ₹202.08 crore.

THREE TRANCHES

The transaction will be completed in three tranches, and is expected to close by March 31, 2027, subject to the fulfilment of conditions under the share purchase agreement.

Following the acquisition, Kirana Club will become a wholly owned subsidiary of Meesho, while Retail Pulse Labs will become its step-down subsidiary.

Meesho will hold 99.59 per cent of Retail Pulse Labs indirectly through Kirana Club, and the remaining 0.41 per cent directly.

Tata Motors hikes car prices by up to 1.5%

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles said it will raise prices of its cars and SUVs by up to 1.5 per cent from July 1. The move, according to industry estimates, could leave some Harrier and Safari variants as much as ₹50,000 costlier than at the start of the fiscal year, and bring the company's electric vehicle portfolio into the price-hike cycle for the first time in FY27.

The increase, which will apply across both internal-combustion engine (ICE) and electric vehicle (EV) models, is aimed at partially offsetting rising input costs and sustained inflationary pressures, with the extent of the revision varying across models and variants, the company said.

For Tata buyers, the July revision effectively creates a second round of hikes within three months for many petrol and diesel models. According to industry estimates, entry models such as Tiago, Tigor and Altroz could now be ₹9,000-16,000 more expensive than before the company's first FY27 price revision.

The cumulative increase rises to roughly ₹10,000-15,000 for the Punch, while buyers of Nexon and Curvv ICE variants may now be paying ₹18,000-28,000 more than at the beginning of the fiscal year.

The biggest impact is visible in Tata's SUV range. Buyers of the Punch, Nexon and Curvv are seeing cumulative increases that run well beyond those on its entry hatchbacks.

At the premium end, cumulative increases on the Harrier and Safari could range between ₹35,000 and ₹50,000. According to industry estimates, Tiago EV could become ₹8,000-12,000 more expensive, Punch EV ₹10,000-15,000 costlier, while Nexon EV and Curvv EV variants may see increases of roughly ₹20,000-28,000 depending on the battery pack and trim levels.

QUICKLY.

Forex reserves fall
\$711 m to \$681.61 b

Mumbai: The country's forex reserves dropped \$711 million to \$681.610 billion during the week ended June 5 due to a sharp decline in foreign currency reserves, the RBI said. In the previous reporting week, the overall reserves had jumped \$938 million to \$682.321 billion. For the week ended June 5, foreign currency assets were down \$2.704 billion to \$543.444 billion, the data released by the Reserve Bank of India showed. **our**

RBI places Mogaveera Co-op Bank under directions

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India has placed Mogaveera Co-operative Bank Ltd, Bombay, under directions for six months, whereby, from the close of business on June 12, it cannot, without the RBI's prior approval, grant or renew any loans and advances, make any investment, incur any liability including borrowing funds and accepting fresh deposits. **our**

BUREAU

Govt proposes common draft broadcasting regulations for both television and radio

Our Bureau

New Delhi

The government on Friday published the draft telecommunication rules related to television, radio and associated services for public consultation.

The proposed rules aim to establish a single regulatory framework for these mediums, extending the existing mandate to air programmes on “themes of national importance and social relevance” from television channels to private radio services.

The draft Telecommunications (Television, Radio and Associated Services) Rules, 2026 state that TV channels would be required to air at least 30 minutes of content every day on themes of national importance and social relevance between 6AM and 11PM. Radio stations will have to dedicate one hour for the same purpose every day.

SET OF RULES

With this set of rules, the industry will now have a unified and significantly simplified rule book. These rules are designed to simplify and harmonise the existing regime while promoting ease of doing business in the television and radio broadcasting sector, the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB) said in the notification.

Microfinance sector shows signs of recovery after seven quarters of contraction

Press Trust of India

Mumbai

The microfinance sector has shown early signs of recovery after a prolonged period of stress, with the industry portfolio witnessing a sequential uptick in the fourth quarter of financial year 2025-26.

“Data for Q4FY26 indicates early signs of recovery in the sector. After seven quarters of portfolio contraction, this quarter witnessed a q-o-q uptick of over 3 per cent,” as per a Micro Finance Industry Network (MFIN) report. As on March 31, the industry portfolio stood at ₹3,25,174 crore.

The portfolio expansion was supported by quarterly disbursement of ₹77,524 crore, which was the highest in the last seven quarters, though still below the peak achieved in Q4FY24, as per the report.

“We can now say that despite the tough two years, industry is turning the corner as evidenced by uptick in portfolio and continued improvement in portfolio at risk...,” said Alok Misra, CEO and Director of MFIN.

India lodges ‘strong protest’ over US attack on commercial vessels

DEEP CONCERN. US envoy summoned twice in three days over Gulf of Oman strikes that killed 3 Indians

Amiti Sen

New Delhi

India summoned US Chargé d’Affaires Jason Meeks on Friday, the second time in three days, and lodged a “strong protest” against the continuing attacks by US naval forces on commercial vessels carrying Indian mariners in the Gulf of Oman, which resulted in the loss of three lives.

DIPLOMATIC MOVE

“The Ministry once again conveyed its deep concern over the use of lethal and deadly force against civilian shipping. Such actions are unacceptable and undermine the safety, security and stability of international maritime commerce in a sensitive region at a difficult time,” the MEA said in a statement.

The high-level diplomatic



UNACCEPTABLE. The Palau-flagged oil tanker MT Settebello, with 24 Indian seafarers on board, was attacked by US forces off the coast of Oman, near the Strait of Hormuz, on June 10 **ANI**

meeting followed American forces “disabling” three commercial ships in the Gulf of Oman this week.

The attack on one of the ships, oil tanker MT Settebello, killed three Indian mar-

iners. In its defence the US Central Command, on Thursday, stated that the vessels had violated the blockade against Iran.

The operator of Settebello said it had no connections

with Iranian oil. “The US Chargé d’Affaires was requested to convey India’s strong concerns to his authorities and to ensure that US forces operating in the region take all necessary

measures to prevent the loss of civilian life,” the MEA statement noted. Iran’s Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei condemned the US attacks.

“The brutal US attacks on Indian commercial vessels which have killed at least three Indian nationals, stand as clear evidence of America’s ongoing policy of armed robbery and State piracy,” Baghaei said in a post on ‘X’.

He said the international community must hold the US accountable for its “lawless conduct”, which threatened global peace and security while endangering the freedom of navigation.

The All India Seafarers Union, in an official statement, expressed its deep concern over the recent attacks on merchant ships and the growing security threats faced by seafarers across international waters.

Rupee rises to one-week high of 95.11 on optimism over US-Iran peace deal

Our Bureau

Mumbai

The rupee was buoyed on Friday, closing at a one-week high, as crude oil prices softened to a three-month low amid rising hopes of a peace deal between the US and Iran and rally in the domestic equity markets.

Opening stronger at 95.35 per US dollar, the rupee closed at 95.11, up about 0.7 per cent, against previous close of 95.76. It tested an intraday high/ low of 94.95/ 95.53.

Crude oil prices thawed to about \$85 per barrel against \$90 on reports of US and Iran inching closer to a peace deal. Benchmark indices BSE Sensex and NSE Nifty rose 2.30 per cent and 1.99 per cent, respectively, due to the possibility of a peace deal and softening oil prices.

Amit Pabari, MD, CR Forex Advisors, said: “The rupee delivered a strong performance today, appreciating below the 95-mark during the session. The move was largely driven by a sharp improvement in global risk sentiment, with markets reacting positively to reports suggesting progress in negotiations between the US and Iran.” Another supportive factor for the rupee has been the evolving global interest-rate environment.

Pabari observed that as major developed economies show limited scope for further rate hikes, capital is likely to flow towards emerging markets in search of better returns, supporting currencies such as the rupee.

STRONG RESISTANCE

“USD/INR continues to face strong resistance in the 96–96.50 zone. As long as oil prices remain contained and foreign inflows stay supportive, the near-term outlook for the rupee remains constructive. A sustained move below 94.80 could gradually pave the way for a test of the 94.50–94 region in the coming weeks,” per his assessment.

Meanwhile, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd (MOFSL), in a report, said the Reserve Bank of India’s latest measures to boost foreign currency inflows are set to strengthen India’s forex reserves, improve banking system liquidity and support the rupee, with total inflows estimated at \$40-50 billion in FY27.

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UNIFIED RULE BOOK

- TV channels would be required to air at least 30 minutes of content daily on themes of national importance and social relevance from 6 am to 11 pm
- Radio stations will have to dedicate one hour for the same purpose every day
- The MIB has sought comments from the stakeholders by July 27

While airing of such content was made obligatory for TV four years ago under the ‘Guidelines for Uplinking and Downlinking of Television Channels in India, 2022’, no time slot was specified in the earlier rules. Therefore, the latest draft seeks to address that gap.

Also, under the FM Policy Phase-III, private radio stations were so far required to broadcast “public interest announcements” for one hour every day “as may be required by the Central government/ State government”.

However, in the draft released on Friday said that every authorised private radio service should “broadcast programmes focusing

on themes of national importance and social relevance, in such manner as the Centre may specify, for a minimum duration of one hour per day”, making the nature of the public interest announcements that they will be expected to make clearer.

Moreover, while the current guidelines says that TV channels “may undertake public service broadcasting”, the draft seeks to change it to “shall”, making the obligation more airtight.

THEMES OF CONTENT

The suggested themes of content — education and spread of literacy, agriculture and rural development, health and family welfare,

science and technology, women’s welfare, welfare of weaker sections of society, protection of environmental and cultural heritage, and national integration — in the existing rules have been retained in the draft.

EXEMPTION

The obligation will exempt certain categories where compliance may not be feasible, it said.

Channels uplinked from India exclusively for foreign audiences will also not be covered, subject to government clearances and ensuring that content does not affect India’s sovereignty, integrity, national security or foreign relations, the draft noted.

Incidentally, a clause in the existing guidelines for television that the Centre may issue a general advisory to channels for telecast of “content in national interest, and the channel shall comply with the same” finds no mention in the draft rules.

The draft retains the existing policy that private radio players can only broadcast the “unaltered news bulletins of Akashwani”, other than certain other “non-news” subjects, including sports events, information related to traffic and weather, examinations, and results. The MIB has sought comments from the stakeholders by July 27.

 HINDUSTAN OIL EXPLORATION COMPANY LIMITED Registered Office: 'HOEC House', Tandalja Road, Off Old Padra Road, Vadodara-390 020. Website: www.hoec.com Email: hoecshare@hoec.com CIN: L11100GJ1996PLC029880											
Extract of statement of standalone and consolidated financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026											
₹ in Lakhs except per share data)											
Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone					Consolidated				
		Quarter ended		Year ended			Quarter ended		Year ended		
		31-Mar-26 (Audited)	31-Dec-25 (Unaudited)	31-Mar-25 (Audited)	31-Mar-26 (Audited)	31-Mar-25 (Audited)	31-Mar-26 (Audited)	31-Dec-25 (Unaudited)	31-Mar-25 (Audited)	31-Mar-26 (Audited)	31-Mar-25 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	-20,331.19	7,785.96	17,901.90	27,462.17	38,498.00	-19,918.34	7,910.64	10,047.20	27,884.26	49,699.34
2	Net Profit for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	3,040.03	1,195.99	13,100.85	7,709.19	14,847.33	900.67	685.83	3,557.68	3,205.60	14,995.13
3	Net Profit for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	3,040.03	1,195.99	13,100.85	10,961.06	14,847.33	900.67	685.83	3,557.68	6,457.47	14,995.13
4	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional items)	3,040.03	1,195.99	13,000.81	10,961.06	14,747.29	776.82	827.56	5,115.93	6,274.53	14,720.77
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	3,103.40	1,219.50	12,988.97	11,028.89	14,709.19	842.54	851.07	5,104.83	6,344.71	14,684.41
6	Equity Share Capital	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93	13,225.93
7	Reserves				1,13,741.57	1,02,712.67				1,25,244.82	1,18,900.11
8	Earnings Per Share (Face value of ₹ 10/-each) Basic EPS ₹ Diluted EPS ₹	(not annualized) ₹ 2.30 ₹ 2.30	(not annualized) ₹ 0.90 ₹ 0.90	(not annualized) ₹ 9.83 ₹ 9.83	(annualized) ₹ 8.29 ₹ 8.29	(annualized) ₹ 11.15 ₹ 11.15	(not annualized) ₹ 0.59 ₹ 0.59	(not annualized) ₹ 0.63 ₹ 0.63	(not annualized) ₹ 3.87 ₹ 3.87	(annualized) ₹ 4.74 ₹ 4.74	(annualized) ₹ 11.13 ₹ 11.13
The above is an extract of detailed format of financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 filed with the stock exchanges under Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of financial results is available on the stock exchange websites www.bseindia.com , www.nseindia.com and Company's website www.hoec.com .											
											
Place : Chennai Date : June 11, 2026											
BY ORDER OF THE BOARD For Hindustan Oil Exploration Company Limited Baroruchi Mishra Managing Director & CEO DIN: 09223144											

Alcobev industry urges Telangana govt to clear ₹3,700 crore pending dues

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

Associations of the Indian alcoholic beverage sector have written to the Telangana government raising their concern regarding the State government’s unilateral decision to start paying for supply of alcoholic beverages after 15 days upon a deduction of 2 per cent cash discount.

The Telangana government has started a new payment mechanism with effect from June 1, under which payments for alcoholic beverage supplied to Telangana State beverage Corporation (TGBCL) in May have been made after 15 days upon deduction of an early payment cash discount of 2-2.75 per cent.

The associations, including the Brewers Association of India (BAI), the International Spirits and Wines Association of India (ISWAI), and the Confederation of Indian Alcoholic Beverage Companies (CIABC), pointed out that while the cash discount is part of the tender conditions, it is intended to be exercised at the request of suppliers, not the buyer, that is, the government.

This, they argued, is against standard accounting practices, as the government has begun making payments for recent dues, while the old undisputed dues of over ₹3,700 crore for the period from December 2025 to April 2026 remain outstanding.

DUES SETTLEMENT

The Associations maintained that settling newer dues before clearing older ones defies established commercial norms and could expose companies to scrutiny from auditors.

The associations are also concerned that the government may divert its monthly payouts towards clearing

The associations point out that while the cash discount is a part of the tender conditions, it is intended to be exercised at the request of suppliers, not the buyer, that is, the government

new dues in order to earn the cash discount, while older outstandings continue to remain unpaid. Over time, this could result in legitimate receivables turning into bad debt, creating massive financial burden and risk for the industry.

In their joint letter to the Telangana government, the three associations said, “We would like to bring to your notice that, as per our records, as on date, payments have been cleared for sale up to first week of December, 2025, and pending payments for the period first week of December to first week of April 2026, to the tune of ₹3,725.73 crore is still pending.

“In light of the above, we find the proposed action by the government to start deducting early payment on current supplies very disturbing and against the principles of normal commercial transactions, and is fraught with non-compliance accounting standards, and subject to scrutiny by auditors.”

The alcoholic beverage industry has instead urged the government to release payments in chronological order and clear the old outstanding immediately.

“We urge you not implement any such proposals as may have been contemplated,” said their joint letter.



SHRIRAM PROPERTIES LIMITED

Corporate Identification Number: L72200TN2000PLC044560

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Corporate Office : Shriram House, No.31, T. Chowdiah Road, 2nd Main, Sadashivnagar, Bengaluru -560080.

Website : <https://www.shriramproperties.com>

Phone: +91 080 4022 9999| Email:cs.spil@shriramproperties.com

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT AND REMOTE EVOTING INFORMATION

Members of the Company are hereby informed that pursuant to the provisions of Sections 108, 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 (the 'Act'), read with Rule 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 (the 'Rules'), as amended from time to time and in compliance with the applicable guidelines/circulars/rules issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs ('MCA') inter alia including latest General Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025, Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, ('Listing Regulations'), Secretarial Standards on General Meetings issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India ('SS-2') and such other applicable laws and regulations (including any statutory modification(s) or amendment(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force), if any, the Company has on Thursday, June 11, 2026 completed the dispatch of Postal Ballot Notice dated May 25, 2026 along with the explanatory statement (the 'Notice') through electronic mode.

The Notice has been sent to all the members, whose names appear in the Register of Members/Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories viz. National Securities Depository Limited (the 'NSDL') and Central Depository Services (India) Limited (the 'CDSL') as on the Cut-off Date, i.e., Friday, June 5, 2026 and whose e-mail addresses are registered with their respective Depository Participants ('DPs') or with Registrar and Share Transfer Agent of the Company i.e., KFin Technologies Limited ('KFin/RTA'), for seeking their approval in respect of the resolution set out in the Notice by means of remote electronic voting ('remote e-Voting').

The Notice is available on the Company's website <https://www.shriramproperties.com>/company-announcements and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited at <https://www.bseindia.com>, National Stock Exchange of India Limited at <https://www.nseindia.com> and on the website of the e-Voting service provider viz., NSDL at <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com>. Members who have not received the Postal Ballot Notice may download it from the above-mentioned websites. A person who is not a Member as on the cut-off date should treat this Notice for information purposes only.

The documents referred to in the Notice are available for inspection electronically. Members seeking to inspect such documents can send an e-mail to cs.spil@shriramproperties.com. Detailed procedure and instructions for remote e-voting including with regard to login credentials for Members, who have not registered their email addresses either with the RTA or their respective DP form part of the Notice.

In accordance with the applicable circulars issued by MCA, the Company is providing to its members the facility to exercise their right to vote on the resolution proposed in the Notice only by remote e-Voting.

Important details regarding the remote e-Voting are specified below: -

Cut-off date for determining Members entitled to vote (voting rights shall be in proportion to the equity shares held as on this date)	Friday, June 5, 2026
Commencement of remote e-Voting	Friday, June 12, 2026, at 09:00 A.M. (IST)
Conclusion of remote e-Voting	Saturday, July 11, 2026, at 05:00 P.M. (IST)

Members may cast their vote electronically during the aforesaid period. Once a vote on a resolution is cast, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently. The remote e-Voting will not be allowed beyond the aforesaid date and time and the e-voting module shall be forthwith disabled by NSDL.

The Board of Directors has appointed Mr. P. Sriaram (FCS: 4862, COP: 3310) and/ or Ms. Nithya Pasupathi (FCS: 10601, COP: 22562), Partners of SPNP Associates, Practicing Company Secretaries, as the Scrutinizer for conducting the Postal Ballot e-Voting process in a fair and transparent manner.

The resolution, if approved, shall be deemed to have been passed on the last date of e-voting i.e. Saturday, July 11, 2026. The results of the Postal Ballot along with the Scrutinizer's Report will be displayed on the Company's website www.shriramproperties.com and on the website of NSDL at <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com> and shall be communicated to BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited, within 2 (two) working days from the end of the remote e-voting period and shall also be displayed at the Registered Office of the Company.

All grievances connected with the facility for voting by electronic means may be addressed to Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Asst. Vice President, NSDL by sending an e-mail to evoting@nsdl.com or call on 022-4886 7000.

Individual Shareholders holding securities in demat mode may contact the respective helpdesk for any technical issues related to login through Depository i.e. NSDL and CDSL Date : June 12, 2026 By Order of the Board Place : Bengaluru

Sd/-

K. Ramaswamy
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No. ACS 28580



A CH-CE

QUICKLY.

Race-inspired Ducati
Desmo450 EDS unveiled



This is the Italian marque's first production enduro motorcycle. Powered by a 449.6 cc single-cylinder engine with desmodromic valve actuation, it produces 63.5 bhp and 5.4 kg-m. Weighing 177 kg without fuel, the EDS is based on Ducati's motocross racer but gains enduro-specific suspension, a larger fuel tank, a 6-speed gearbox and road-legal equipment. The motorcycle also features traction control, riding modes and connectivity, bringing Ducati's racing-derived technology to the enduro segment.

Audi reveals third-gen Q7
featuring advanced tech



The popular German SUV now flaunts a sharper design, a thoroughly revamped cabin and offers greater flexibility. Available in five-, six- and seven-seat configurations, the luxury SUV is powered by a 3.0-litre V6 diesel engine producing up to 299 bhp and 63.2 kg-m, paired with mild-hybrid technology and quattro all-wheel drive. New sophisticated lighting setup, triple-screen displays and an optional panoramic glass roof headline the technology upgrades. Expect the car's debut here by mid next year.

Jawa showcases 1000 Sport
Cruiser concept



The Jawa name has returned to the spotlight in Europe with the unveiling of the 1000 Sport Cruiser Concept at the Brno Motorcycle Show. Importantly, this motorcycle has no connection to the Classic Legends-owned Jawa brand sold in India. Developed by Czech manufacturer Jawa Moto, the concept uses a 999 cc parallel-twin engine producing 113 bhp and 9.7 kg-m. Weighing around 240 kg, it features premium hardware including Ohlins suspension, Brembo brakes and OZ Racing wheels. Production, however, is expected to be limited to just a handful of motorcycles.

@TheMotorGram



KAIZAD ADIL DARUKHANAWALA

Talk of the Town

CITY PLANNER. Is Honda's attempt at giving the City a dash of freshness enough to keep it relevant?

Ruman Devmane

For an elaborate moment, we were traversing through a field. The navigation app had insisted this was a road and yet it clearly wasn't. We were on an off-road course of the kind that would make most compact SUVs quiver. Behind the wheel of the updated Honda City e:HEV, I was cautious and keen on not scraping its underside. It was no place to drive, a low-slung sedan or otherwise. That we emerged incident-free was not merely a matter of luck. The Honda City is a car that wears India on its sleeve. Once upon a time, not long ago, it served as an important milestone of India's automotive aspirations and to a few, it remains so. But, of course, we live in the age of the SUV now and three-box sedans, such as the City, are rapidly losing relevance. Where's the appeal in a car that actually looks like one, right?

To counter this, Honda has attempted to give the City a comprehensive visual makeover and thrown in a few feature updates as well. Riding on the credibility of its naturally-aspirated powertrain and e:HEV tech, the 2026 City aims to be more compelling than ever before. Is it, though?

CITY SLICKER

For sure, it's an appealing design especially in the flesh, with its clean and minimalist front end with a prominent connected light bar, a sporty-ish stance in profile and the revised rear end with clear lens taillamps, and a diffuser integrated into the bumper. The 16-inch aero-style alloys (there's a space-saver in the boot) gel well with the rest of the car, too. Youthful? Sure. Enough to make you forego your SUV dreams? Subjective.

That responsibility is shouldered by the cabin, which is of the sort

that grows on you with its simplicity and understated premiumness. It isn't perhaps instantly impressive or sensational, but over the tenure of ownership, here's a cabin you'll find yourself very comfortable in. The steering wheel (not flat-bottomed) has a smooth, soft rim to it, the plastics for the steering-mounted controls feel good and it's only the hub, with its dated, textured plastic, that's a bit visually underwhelming.

The revised dashboard layout is rather tasteful, with the two layers (black/beige) being separated by a strip of grey trim that conceals the ambient lighting (also featured in the doors and footwell). The touchscreen, however, is just odd, courtesy its upward-angled orientation. This not only makes daytime reading difficult but also makes the far ends of the screen quite challenging to access on the move. Since screen-dependence for driving functions is non-existent (as it should be), it isn't a complete red flag, though. The digital information cluster retains its simple design, and quickly disables its ADAS functions using the steering-mounted controls.

The climate control stack, for one, looks as good as it feels to use and the three rotary clickers feel great to operate while being super intuitive in their layout. There's a compact shelf for your phone, a pair of cupholders, all finished in a sort of hard-wearing plastic, and there's even a wireless charger under the armrest. Oh, and I love that Honda continues to dedicate a large, round physical button to the sole purpose of dimming the instrument cluster; that's just very insightful. The City also features a retractable sunshade for the rear windscreen, which is a very thoughtful touch. There's a sunroof, too, of course.

The seats up front are just right. I was surprised to see the lack of electronic adjustability — that's a shocker! — but, having found my



INSIDE PEEK. The City's cabin is understated but premium. Dash layout is contemporary although the touchscreen is oddly oriented KAIZAD ADIL DARUKHANAWALA

ideal driving position, I soon forgot about this feature miss; perhaps that says something about its utility from a single-user perspective? Moving on, outward visibility is really quite good and while the 360-degree camera's display output is laughably low-res, this isn't a car you'll struggle with in traffic or trying to slot into a tight parking space. This is further accentuated by the light steering which really feels soothing, even for longer stints in traffic. Really, why are we so SUV-crazy?

The backseat is comfortable but not exceptional. Legroom is decent, headroom feels somewhat constrained and underthigh support seems average. It's no departure from earlier models of the City but

rather a sign of why SUVs tend to win favour among the masses today. A small oversight is the armrest design, which is hinged so as to fold down all the way to the seat base, requiring a bit of a lean-in for you to actually be able to use it. Could certainly be better!

NATURAL RESOURCES

Honda has remained bullish on naturally-aspirated engines, in this case a 1.5-litre four-cylinder unit that produces a combined 107.5 bhp (98.6 bhp from the engine, with the surplus supplied by the hybrid motor) and is paired to an e-CVT. The non-hybrid produces 119.3 bhp and gets the option of either a 6-speed manual or a CVT. The former configuration works really well for

those looking for a seamless nonsense runabout that delivers great efficiency (Honda claims 27.26 kpl as per CMVR guidelines) and gets the job done.

If a sporty flavour is what you're looking for, though, you'll have to look elsewhere. The eCVT certainly feels laborious under aggressive driving, although on the whole, the City's powertrain feels smooth and refined. On balance, this configuration sure may have its cost advantages, especially in terms of maintenance and long-term reliability. If that matters to you, then you'll have to learn to love its character.

On the dynamics front, the City is just delightful. Braking and stability are both really good, and the handling is really enjoyable. Spirited cornering comes naturally to the City, although the Bridgestone Ecopia tyres seem to underplay its true potential.

Ride quality is, just like on the earlier City, very pliant and the suspension adds a surprising dose of toughness to the mix, something Honda will do well to advertise! As I found out over my misadventure mentioned at the beginning of this story, the City really can cope with some properly bad roads.

To summarise, the City is a pleasant car with a nice cabin, good features, a great boot, impressive efficiency and the promise of long-term dependability. Why, then, must you not consider it? For one, the top-spec's ₹21.07 lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi) price tag is a tad too steep, especially in comparison to what else that kind of money can buy you today. You can, however, have the base City (petrol, manual) at ₹12.07 lakh or the base automatic, which starts from ₹14.37 lakh. Does it make sense to buy the non-hybrid for far less and consider the savings as fuel money? I'd think so. Just try walking right past that Elevate, though.

@TheMotorGram

Start Here

FIRST MOVER. The Tata Tiago CNG has seriously stepped up the game with its clever packaging. Just the first car you should consider, then?



KAIZAD ADIL DARUKHANAWALA



A STEP FORWARD. The cabin is a lot more appealing courtesy the new trim, clean layout and improved plastics. CNG twin-tanks are neatly integrated KAIZAD ADIL DARUKHANAWALA

Ruman Devmane

A strategic error on Tata's part was to let me drive the Tiago ICE after the EV. In all honesty, the ICE and EV feel significantly different, and it's not just owing to the powertrain. Why am I starting the story here, though? So that you get your test-drive experience right! For now, I'll reserve most of my Tiago.ev thoughts for a separate story that is to follow.

STOP, LOOK, GO!
Like the way the Tiago's looking

in the shots? I do and it's an interesting approach for sure. The cleaner styling definitely makes the Tiago look crisp and slightly butch (it was never a bad looker anyway), and it looks good in most of the pastel shades it's offered in. If the connected taillamps excite you, allow me to inform you, the bit in the centre is purely a reflector. The '14-inch wheels' (caps, not alloys) are in keeping with the times although the 15-inchers are reserved for the pure petrol variant.

An equally tedious amount of work has been extended to the cabin, which now boasts a refreshing look and feel. There's a

fabric mesh-like trim, a tasteful grey, which looks very good. On our test car (both versions), though, the trim had already scuffed and worn out noticeably.

The overall layout is new with a neat touchscreen, lots of good-quality physical buttons, a new steering wheel (fortunately, without the piano black centre band), a good use of overall plastics and also a smaller instrument display, which I loved for its compactness. There's a 360-camera, a lane-watch display and a decent audio system as well!

FUN? SORT OF

In case you've grown suspicious,

no, these frills aren't a method of distraction. The Tiago iCNG is pretty nifty to drive as well! It's powered by a 1.2-litre three-cylinder engine, which churns out 74.4 bhp (the pure petrol produces 84.8 bhp); our test car came with a 5-speed AMT, but there is a 5-speed manual on offer, too. Quite cleverly, the Tiago features a twin-tank CNG setup, which essentially offers an 8-9 kg capacity (same as, say, on a WagonR), but the two leaner tanks don't protrude as much into the boot. There's a load-bearing frame around the tanks, too, so you can comfortably stow a few small bags on it.

In the city, its compactness and

spirited attitude makes for a fun combination. Okay, it's no scorcher, but considering most Tiago owners may be first-time drivers, it's a pretty good package.

I can't say refinement is of a very high degree and the AMT certainly feels basic, but on friendliness and ease of operation, it scores really well. The brakes felt quite confident and the tyres seemed adequate even under aggressive driving. What I found quite impressive was its high-speed stability; it's not a car you'll feel out of place in, on the highway. Now, since the Tiago isn't a tall-boy design, it certainly isn't big on space. At the front,

you won't notice this (the large windows certainly help), but the backseat is definitely no place for fully-grown adults. At least not for long stints. It's here that the Tiago feels the constraints of its platform and while kids (or adults with a below-average frame) may not struggle, its peers definitely have the edge over it.

Which of the two ICE versions of the Tiago must you consider? If frills don't matter to you, the base petrol (manual), starting at ₹4.69

lakh (ex-showroom, Delhi) is good enough. If CNG is a must, however, the starting point is ₹5.79 lakh, going all the way up to ₹8.54 lakh for the top-end CNG AMT (our test unit). Is the CNG worth the premium? Certainly, and it's also got the highest cumulative range — think upwards of 600 km, easy. What about the EV, though? You'll have to wait just a bit longer for our take on that!

@TheMotorGram

QUICKLY.

S&P 500, Nasdaq turn volatile in choppy trading



Benchmarks S&P 500 and Nasdaq see-sawed between marginal gains and losses on Friday, ahead of the market debut of Elon Musk's SpaceX, while hopes for an imminent West Asia peace deal buoyed overall sentiment. US President Donald Trump's comments on Thursday suggested that a deal to end the West Asia conflict and reopen the crucial Strait of Hormuz could be signed as early as this weekend. However, Tehran said that the final decision was pending At 10:26 am ET, the Dow Jones rose 175.90 points, or 0.35 per cent, to 51,027.28, the S&P 500 gained 15.55 points, or 0.21 per cent, to 7,409.88 and the Nasdaq gained 1.31 points, nearly flat, to 25,810.97. REUTERS

Liotech Industries to raise ₹36 crore via NSE-SME

Mumbai: Liotech Industries, a leading manufacturer of precision hardware structures and accessories, including door kits, hinges, hooks, aldrops, locks and handles, plans to raise ₹36 crore through an initial public offering (IPO) on the NSE SME platform. The company will issue 11.22 lakh shares at a price of ₹321 per share. The issue will open for subscription on June 17. The net proceeds from the IPO will be used for capital expenditure towards acquiring machinery, repayment of loan, working capital and general corporate purposes. Wealth Mine Networks will be the lead manager to the issue and KFIN Technologies has been appointed as the registrar. OUR BUREAU

BROKER'S CALL.

PL Capital

RAINBOW CHILDREN'S MEDICARE (BUY)
Target: ₹1,700
CMP: ₹1,363.65
Rainbow Children's Medicare delivered modest EBITDA growth of 11 per cent CAGR over FY23-26, reflecting the absorption of about 780 beds added during its aggressive expansion cycle, which has now largely concluded. The company continues to benefit from industry-leading margins, strong FCF generation, a net cash balance sheet, and healthy return ratios, aided by its asset-light hub-and-spoke model, unique position as India's only integrated multi-specialty pediatric healthcare platform, and differentiated full-time doctor engagement model. The slowdown in FY26 was largely driven by seasonal headwinds and start-up losses of new bed commissioning. Recently, Rainbow has strengthened its growth engine through leadership appointments, including a new CEO, Chief Growth Officer and hiring new clinical talents with more focus on tertiary and quaternary cases. This will aid better clinical mix and help them to reduce dependence on seasonality. Overall, we expect mature unit's occupancy to normalize toward 56-58 per cent in FY28 from current level of 51 per cent. Further upside is expected from the gradual ramp-up of the international patient business. With newly commissioned capacities entering the ramp-up phase and occupancy levels expected to improve, we forecast Pre-IND-AS EBITDA growth of 20 per cent CAGR over FY26-FY28E. We recommend 'Buy' rating with TP of ₹1,700/share, based on 26x FY28E Pre-IND-AS EV/EBITDA.

JM Financial

EQUITAS SFB (ADD)
Target: ₹77
CMP: ₹75.53
We attended Equitas Small Finance Bank's analyst day, and management commentary indicates that the bank is entering the next phase of its evolution after several years of portfolio diversification, liability franchise build-up and technological investments. The transformation of the loan book is the most important takeaway from the analyst day. MFI exposure has reduced from over 50 per cent at the time of bank conversion in FY17 to about 10 per cent currently, whereas secured portfolio has increased to around 88 per cent. Growth is increasingly driven by SBL, affordable housing, vehicle finance and gold loans. Management expects further gains from current accounts, affluent banking, NRI banking and cross-sell initiatives while technological investments and AI-led processes should support operating leverage. However, deposit mobilisation remains the most critical execution variable as sustaining about 20 per cent loan growth and achieving management's profitability aspirations will require continued improvement in liability productivity and funding costs. That said, deposit mobilisation and execution on profitability targets are the key areas to monitor. We are increasing FY27E/28E EPS by +4/5 per cent and the target FY28E P/BV to 1.2x (from 1x), yielding a revised TP of ₹77 (earlier ₹65). We are, hence, upgrading Equitas to Add (from Reduce).

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Indian retail investors keen to buy SpaceX shares post listing

SPIKE IN INTEREST. Platforms that offer global stocks to domestic investors see huge traction on SpaceX effect

Rohan Das
Chennai

As Elon Musk's SpaceX goes public in what is the largest ever IPO in history, Indian retail investors too are eager to get a piece of the soon-to-be \$1.75 trillion space and technology company. Speaking to *businessline*, foreign investing platforms note an outsized interest among Indian retail investors for SpaceX compared with any previous global IPOs.

RETAIL ACCESS
Though the US IPO process does not reserve shares for retail investors from India, companies allot shares to specific brokers or investment bankers, which may

then offer them to eligible retail clients. Viram Shah, Founder and CEO, Vested Finance, a global investing platform, said that the SpaceX ticker, connected to the Nasdaq feed, is already live on the platform, and users are actively searching for it. "We have seen a surge in traffic on our platform as investors want to know more about this listing. Marquee IPOs always lead to traction but this has been unprecedented," he said.

He added that many customers are also making enquiries through social media and Vested's community forums.

Shah said that retail investor demand for SpaceX could be seen even before the IPO. "For instance,



BOARDING PASS. SpaceX signs at the Nasdaq in New York ahead of the company's initial public offering BLOOMBERG

private market vehicles like the Destiny Tech Fund (DXYZ), which holds shares in SpaceX, and is available on the Vested platform have seen strong traction" he said.

Sitashwa Srivastava, Founder and CEO of Borderless, another such platform,

predicted that if the IPO allocation had been available to Indian retail investors, the demand could have translated into \$50-100 million worth of investments.

He said that despite some concerns about the valuations, he expects the plat-

form's daily trading volume to more than double on Saturday after listing, driven largely by SpaceX-related demand.

Prathik Desai, a chartered accountant who has been investing in major US tech companies said, that he definitely plans to invest in the company and to hold the shares in the long term. "I will not immediately buy SpaceX once it is listed. I am going to wait for some corrections for a few weeks. But there is a lot of upside in the long run," he said.

Data from the RBI shows that Indian investors interest in foreign equity continues to rise. Remittances under LRS relating to investment in foreign equity/debt, grew 56 per cent y-o-y to \$2.7 billion in FY26.

Dhan launches platform to deal in US stocks, ETFs

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Dhan on Friday launched investment access to US-listed stocks and exchange-traded funds for Indian investors through the GIFT City.

The offering is being provided through Raise IFSC Private Ltd, Dhan's wholly owned subsidiary and a member of India INX operating under the regulatory framework of the International Financial Services Centres Authority. Dhan has partnered with ViewTrade for brokerage service and GlomoPay for payment technology services to facilitate investments in US securities.

SAT to hear five offshore funds' plea against SEBI adjudication process on June 22

Our Bureau
Mumbai



The Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) on Friday adjourned appeals filed by five offshore funds challenging the manner in which adjudication proceedings have been initiated by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) for a detailed hearing on June 22.

The markets regulator's counsel, senior advocate Chetan Kapadia, said they will file a short note within a week.

These five funds, LTS Investment Fund, Cresta Fund, Asia Investment Cor-

poration (Mauritius), APMS Investment Fund and Albula Investment Fund, were named in the Hindenburg report from January 2023.

Senior advocate Zal Andhyarujina, appearing for the funds, argued that after receiving a response to a show-cause notice, an adjudicating officer is required to form and communicate an

opinion on whether proceedings should continue, under Rule 4(3) of SEBI's adjudication regulations.

"The short but important question raised here is whether the adjudicating officer, after issuing a show-cause notice and inviting a reply, is required under the rules to issue a preliminary opinion, giving reasons on whether he is to proceed further or not," he submitted before the tribunal.

"The first thing he said is that I am not bound to do it. Secondly, he said I am not bound to give it to you," Andhyarujina said, adding that the officer subsequently provided reasons only after

the funds approached SAT. Though these are merely a "mechanical reproduction" of the show-cause notice and did not satisfy the requirement contemplated under Rule 4(3), he said.

INTERIM RELIEF

The funds have further sought a direction restraining the adjudicating officer from proceeding further until a proper opinion is issued after considering their replies.

To which SEBI's counsel said that the regulator had followed the process prescribed under the rules but the funds "don't want the inquiry to proceed."

Independent director and 'relative' conundrum

RINGSIDE VIEW.



KS BADRI NARAYANAN

The Securities and Exchange Board of India's (SEBI) recent clarification on independent directors has caught many stakeholders, particularly corporate governance and taxation experts, by surprise.

In response to an informal guidance request from Maithan Alloys regarding the appointment of a promoter's cousin as an independent director, SEBI observed that the Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements (LODR) Regulations, 2015, do not prohibit such an appointment.

Maithan Alloys proposed appointing an academic professional as an independent director.

The proposed appointee, who holds advanced management qualifications and serves as an assistant professor at a business school, is a cousin of Siddhartha Shankar Agarwalla, a member of the company's promoter group and a director

in two of its subsidiaries.

WHO IS A RELATIVE?

According to the application, the proposed director is the daughter of Agarwalla's father's sister. Maithan Alloys argued that Section 2(1)(zd) of the SEBI LODR Regulations does not classify a cousin as a "relative".

Under Section 2(77) of the Companies Act, "relative" includes members of a Hindu Undivided Family, husband and wife, father, mother, son, son's wife, daughter, daughter's husband, brother, sister, step-brother and stepsister.

SEBI accepted the company's interpretation and concluded that the proposed appointee could be appointed as an independent director, subject to meeting all other eligibility requirements, since a cousin does not fall within the definition of "relative" under either the Companies Act or the SEBI LODR Regulations.

The broad expectation is that an independent director is a non-executive board member who enhances corporate credibility and governance standards by exercising objective and



CLEAN GOVERNANCE. An independent director is expected to be free from relationships that could compromise independence

unbiased judgment. Such a director is expected to be free from relationships that could compromise independence.

Among the key responsibilities of independent directors are bringing objective judgment to board deliberations on strategy, performance, risk management and governance; evaluating management performance; balancing stakeholder interests; safeguarding minority shareholders; and playing a crucial role in determining executive remuneration and key management appointments.

Keeping these principles in mind, the SEBI-appointed Uday Kotak Committee on

corporate governance

concerns. Just days after SEBI's clarification, the regulator, in an interim order against Rajesh Exports, alleged that the company had prima facie overstated nearly ₹15.15 lakh crore of revenues attributable to its subsidiaries during FY21-FY25.

According to SEBI, the alleged misstatement accounted for around 99.8 per cent of the revenues attributed to the company's overseas subsidiaries and step-down subsidiaries, creating what it described as an "inflated and misleading picture" of operations.

The interim order sent shock waves through the investment community and reignited questions about the effectiveness of board oversight and the role of independent directors.

SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey recently remarked at the CII Corporate Governance Summit that, in many cases, independence exists only in form and does not translate into action.

Against this backdrop, it may be time to revisit the Kotak Committee's recommendations.

Hexagon Nutrition ends 12.6% higher at ₹50.66 on listing day

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Hexagon Nutrition shares rallied sharply on its stock market debut on Friday, ending at the upper circuit after listing at a premium of around 7 per cent over the issue price.

The stock debuted at ₹48 on the BSE, a premium of 6.66 per cent to its issue price of ₹45 per share. On the NSE, the stock listed at ₹48.25, reflecting a premium of 7.2 per cent.

Following the listing, buying interest gathered momentum, pushing the stock to its upper circuit limits of ₹50.66 on the NSE and ₹50.39 on the BSE, a gain of 12.6 per cent and 12 per cent respectively. Ravi Singh,



HEALTHY DEBUT. Ashish Chauhan (second from left), MD and CEO, NSE, with officials of Hexagon Nutrition at the listing. The company's shares remained resilient through the day

Chief Research Officer, Master Capital Services, highlighted the company's leadership in pre-mixes and micronutrient products, along with its portfolio of nutrition brands and supply relationships with FMCG companies and UN programmes.

Singh maintained a positive long-term outlook on the

Bonfiglioli, Casagrand, two others get SEBI nod for IPOs

Our Bureau
Chennai



Market regulator SEBI has cleared draft papers of four companies — Bonfiglioli Transmissions, Casagrand Premier Builder, Bombay Coated & Special Steels Ltd and Swaraj Green Power and Fuel Ltd — to launch initial public offerings.

Bonfiglioli Transmissions Ltd, one of India's largest technology-led mechanical and electro-mechanical power transmissions and industrial drive solutions providers, has received observations from SEBI for its proposed IPO.

The offer comprises an offer for sale (OFS) aggregating up to 4.70 crore shares by Bonfiglioli SpA (promoter selling shareholder). The face value of each share is ₹10.

Bonfiglioli Transmissions Ltd is a part of Italy's Bonfiglioli SpA, manufactures gearboxes and drives for original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) and end-users engaged in industry and automation solutions (gear motors < 15 kNm), off-highway mobility and wind industries.

CASAGRAND

The IPO of Chennai-based Casagrand consists of a fresh issue up to ₹1,200 crore and an OFS up to ₹20 crore by promoters Arun MN and Casagrand Luxor Pvt Ltd.

The proceeds from its fresh issuance worth ₹250 crore will be utilised for pre-payment or repayment, in full or in part, of all or a portion of certain outstanding borrowings availed by the company, ₹650 crore for pre-payment or repayment, in full or part, of all or a portion of certain outstanding borrowings availed by its wholly owned subsidiaries, CG M-gick, CG Civil Engineering,

CG Fresh, CG Bizpark, CG Shelter, CG Lotus, CG Everta, CG Hyderabad, CG Zingo, and wholly owned step-down subsidiaries, CG Anchor and Danub Homes, through investment in such wholly owned subsidiaries/step-down subsidiaries, and general corporate purposes.

BOMBAY COATED

The Mumbai-based Bombay Coated & Special Steels is entirely a fresh issue up of to ₹191 crore.

The proceeds from its fresh issuance worth ₹125 crore will be utilised for pre-payment/repayment of certain outstanding borrowings availed by the Company, in part or full; ₹18 crore for financing the cost towards acquisition of capital equipment under existing lease arrangements with Siemens Financial Services Private Limited, and general corporate purposes.

The company caters to a diversified customer base comprising original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) and original design manufacturers (ODMs).

The company, being a steel processing centre (SPC), operates as an intermediary between primary steel producers and end-users by providing value-added processing services.

SWARAJ GREEN

Swaraj Green Power & Fuel Ltd has confidentially filed its draft IPO papers with SEBI on March 16.

The proposed issue comprises both a fresh issue and an OFS.

Nifty 50 Movers					
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
HDFC Bank	772.45	93.08	15.01	10.93	
L&T	4049.30	48.02	29.39	4.39	
Reliance Ind.	1293.00	44.25	18.27	8.07	
ICICI Bank	1340.80	37.16	16.57	8.86	
Bajaj Finance	918.30	27.89	29.56	2.27	
Bharti Airtel	1822.50	26.74	32.83	5.17	
Axis Bank	1356.30	24.44	15.88	3.60	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	954.95	21.01	22.41	1.24	
Kotak Bank	403.30	16.00	20.80	2.74	
State Bank	1017.15	14.31	10.70	3.90	
Titan	4184.00	14.31	73.21	1.60	
Eternal Ltd.	243.80	13.53	642.83	1.62	
Int'lGlobeAvi	4709.70	10.24	0.00	0.98	
M&M	3042.90	8.20	20.32	2.51	
Maruti Suzuki	13366.00	7.68	28.63	1.62	
UltraTech Cement	11117.00	7.42	40.01	1.22	
Tata Motors PV	390.00	6.45	4787.41	0.76	
TCS	2161.40	5.75	15.81	2.04	
ITC	285.10	5.68	17.00	2.54	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	235.89	5.64	96.01	0.72	
Hind Unilever	2168.80	5.62	48.16	1.78	
Asian Paints	2747.40	5.58	59.97	1.15	
Bajaj Finserv	1689.10	5.37	13.74	0.56	
Adani Ports	1812.90	4.16	32.68	1.24	
Eicher Motors	7312.00	3.98	36.37	0.93	
Bharat Elec	406.50	3.29	49.02	1.35	
Trent Ltd.	2755.30	3.23	85.35	0.85	
JSW Steel	1297.60	3.13	12.44	1.12	
Tata Steel	1807.70	3.12	37.69	1.77	
Sun Pharma	555.35	2.27	62.66	0.55	
HDFC Life	353.90	2.12	12.46	1.55	
Wipro	180.14	1.73	14.24	0.48	
Infosys	1116.40	1.38	15.36	3.62	
Grasim Ind	3105.50	1.33	20.52	1.00	
Adani Enter	2921.60	0.80	37.93	0.77	
Cipla	1389.40	0.79	29.62	1.92	
Max Healthcare	1012.45	0.46	68.31	0.70	
Apollo Hosp	8498.00	0.11	61.01	0.81	
Dr Reddys Lab	1275.40	-0.08	25.60	0.72	
HCL Tech	1109.60	-0.14	18.08	1.08	
Tata Steel	197.86	-0.18	22.69	1.51	
Hindalco	1021.50	-0.85	17.14	1.37	
TataConsumerProduct	1100.70	-1.12	70.42	0.60	
Bajaj Auto	10063.00	-1.23	26.60	1.03	
SBI Life	1706.00	-1.28	69.27	0.71	
Coal India	447.50	-1.34	8.80	0.93	
PowerGrid Corp	284.80	-1.83	16.63	1.19	
Tech Mahindra	1429.20	-4.98	29.14	0.84	
ONGC	246.20	-5.43	6.22	0.98	
NestleIndia	1375.70	-7.33	75.81	0.91	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 1,628.45 pts.
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Tata Motors Cv	390.30	188.89	47.46	3.30	
Cholamandalam&Fin	1568.10	137.14	25.53	2.71	
Bpcl	302.35	91.73	5.08	2.48	
Adani Power.	223.07	88.46	33.16	3.73	
Indian Oilcorp	140.94	70.81	4.56	2.13	
Indian Hotels Co.	679.45	59.00	43.04	2.41	
Siemens Energy India .	3606.90	48.64	98.07	1.29	
Muthootfin	3042.20	46.17	11.51	1.32	
Dif	587.05	43.64	32.92	1.52	
Rural Elec	348.05	39.57	5.42	1.76	
Hdfc Amc	2455.90	38.10	36.81	2.02	
Bank Of Baroda	274.75	37.52	7.08	2.06	
Bosch	39060.00	36.68	41.54	1.37	
Bajaj Holdings	10161.00	36.50	11.55	1.78	
Gail (India)	170.50	33.65	14.79	1.86	
Sarmadarmothersinternat	143.40	33.30	37.05	2.56	
Piplidint	1535.50	32.20	63.25	1.92	
Power Finance	421.05	30.89	4.13	2.48	
Union Bank	170.05	30.12	6.68	1.33	
AdaniGreenenergy	1485.70	29.59	123.16	2.01	
Ambuja Cements	423.10	29.41	19.03	1.04	
Jindal Steel	1148.50	28.50	34.86	1.72	
Godrej Consumer	1033.30	27.77	56.80	1.68	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	914.45	25.42	120.34	2.54	
Macrotech Developers .	899.30	24.89	26.18	1.02	
Cummins India	5621.50	24.65	65.98	3.07	
Vedanta	309.65	22.83	7.64	2.13	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1489.60	22.47	74.79	2.09	
Hyundai Motor India .	1590.10	20.17	29.77	1.15	
Windsor Zinc	559.90	18.27	17.10	0.98	
Shree Cement	24175.00	17.97	49.88	1.31	
Britannia	5165.50	17.50	49.04	2.46	
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3312.80	16.87	49.39	3.14	
Tata Power	393.55	15.63	24.57	2.66	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	95.89	14.57	17.88	0.78	
Mazagon Dock	2410.10	13.45	35.28	0.74	
United Spirits .	1272.40	12.20	49.57	1.52	
Siemens	3666.60	11.90	82.93	1.27	
HindustanAeronautics	4192.30	10.73	30.76	3.21	
Vinvar Beverages .	522.20	8.90	55.03	2.89	
Abb Pharma	4571.20	7.64	94.80	2.00	
Punjab Natk Bank	106.88	6.93	6.45	1.49	
Tata Capital	326.55	5.74	28.30	0.57	
Limtiredree	3844.70	5.20	22.88	1.44	
Avenuesuper	3993.60	2.75	87.50	2.38	
Canara Bank	131.67	1.43	6.68	1.79	
Solar Industries	17143.00	1.04	89.33	1.69	
Torrent Pharma	4671.20	-0.30	73.36	1.65	
ZydusIntelligence	1163.00	-0.85	21.02	1.12	
Divis Lab	6638.70	-2.29	68.62	3.41	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

Fake glitter

Rajesh Exports yet again shows up shocking audit lapses

Ordinarily, when Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) issues an order against a listed company for overstating its revenues by ₹15 lakh crore over five years, you would expect ripples in the stock market. However, SEBI’s recent interim order, alleging that 99.8 per cent of Rajesh Exports’ (REL) revenues of ₹15.45 lakh crore could not be verified, hasn’t caused much of a furore. Most market players were hesitant to take the company’s reported revenues at face value — which is why the stock traded at a market capitalisation of just ₹3,200 crore.

The SEBI investigation has uncovered many accounting irregularities. One, though REL’s revenues are derived mainly from its step-down Switzerland-based subsidiary Valcambi SA, there was a yawning mismatch between its own reported annual revenues of ₹2-5 lakh crore and Valcambi’s revenues of less than ₹1,000 crore between FY21 and FY25. While the Swiss subsidiary, a gold refining company, recognised only its processing charges as revenue, REL has evaluated revenues at the gross value of gold refined in its consolidated P&L. Two, REL’s subsidiary Global Gold Refineries AG which owns Valcambi and whose accounts were consolidated to arrive at these revenues, wasn’t audited either in Switzerland or India. Three, the promoter’s personal derivative trades were recorded as REL’s. Related party transactions remained undisclosed. Though the company made provisions of over ₹1,000 crore towards investing in gold mines in Africa, there was no physical evidence of those gold mines. All this obviously flags gross negligence in the discharge of their duties by REL’s statutory auditors.

In view of these lapses, SEBI’s penal actions in its interim order seem mild. Holding off monetary penalties, SEBI has merely restrained REL’s promoters from dealing in the company’s shares, directed REL to make true and fair disclosures of its financials, appointed a second forensic auditor to go into accounts and flagged audit-related issues to the National Financial Reporting Authority (NFRA) for further action. Whether SEBI decides to take more stringent action in its final order remains to be seen. The main lesson from the REL saga for retail investors seems to be that, when investing in under-researched small-cap companies, caveat emptor is the only rule that applies.

Successive corporate governance scandals beginning with IL&FS, have shown that companies that operate through a labyrinth of subsidiaries are suspect. Statutory auditors of the holding company don’t seem to take the audit of subsidiary accounts seriously. While the REL stock is not held by mutual funds, LIC (10.8 per cent stake) features as a key shareholder along with a few FIIs (14.2 per cent). It is indeed a mystery how LIC held on to REL for so long. It is also not clear how, despite being a past defaulter on bank dues, REL made the cut for the Production-Linked Incentive scheme for advanced chemical cell batteries. It has managed with its fake glitter for way too long.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

Setback for Labour as well as Keir Starmer

John Healey’s resignation as defence secretary on Thursday morning was genuinely shocking. Mr Healey is not just a veteran minister, but a Labour loyalist who previously served both Tony Blair and Jeremy Corbyn. In an interview in March, he observed that he didn’t toil to rebuild confidence in Labour “just to see that wasted with internal chatter and commentary”. Now he has maximised external chatter with a withering denunciation of the prime minister and chancellor. In his resignation letter, Mr Healey said that Sir Keir Starmer was “unable” and the Treasury “unwilling” to provide the budget needed to protect the UK – forcing him to make decisions that increased the risk to personnel and could make the country less safe. LONDON, JUNE 11



World Cup should be platform for global unity

The FIFA World Cup 2026 has finally arrived. The tournament kicks off on Thursday in Mexico City, where Mexico will face South Africa in the opening match. Featuring an expanded roster of 48 teams and a record-breaking 104 matches over 39 days, the global event, which will unfold across an unprecedented three host nations — Canada, Mexico and the United States — is the largest ever. Embodying the spirit of excellence and mutual respect, the World Cup traditionally provides a rare moment when political, cultural and ethnic differences give way to a shared passion for the beautiful game. Yet this year’s tournament has kicked off with a seemingly chaotic buildup, limiting its potential to become a huge worldwide celebration that transcends sports. BEIJING, JUNE 11



SC order can spur insurance for homemakers

GENDER PARITY. The apex court’s landmark judgment has fixed a homemaker’s income at ₹30,000 per month. The financial architecture must now respond



On June 11, the Supreme Court fixed a minimum notional income of ₹30,000 per month for homemakers, created a distinct head of compensation called “loss of domestic care” in motor accident claims, and mandated a 10 per cent increase in this floor every three years. In doing so, it recognised unpaid domestic work as a measurable economic contribution and ended the discretion that tribunals had exercised, inconsistently and often inadequately, for decades.

The bench’s observation carries more weight than the number itself. It is ironic, Justices Sanjay Karol and NK Singh noted, to describe a homemaker as dependent on earning members when the household’s functioning depends substantially on the homemaker. Motor Vehicles Act tribunals had long valued such a life by instinct rather than principle. The June 11 judgment ends that. The homemaker is now a nation builder, in the court’s own word, with a court-validated minimum contribution that claimants and their lawyers can hold to.

The economic data the bench cited deserves wider attention. Drawing on India’s Time Use Survey and international studies, the court noted that women spend over seven hours a day on unpaid domestic tasks, perform nearly 2.6 times more unpaid caregiving work than men, and contribute an estimated 15-17 per cent of India’s GDP

through this labour. That figure appears nowhere in the national accounts. Conventional GDP measurement excludes household production entirely. The Supreme Court has corrected one slice of that distortion. The principle it has established, however, reaches well beyond accident compensation.

INSURANCE GAP Insurance has not moved with the law, and the ruling now makes that gap indefensible. A homemaker seeking life insurance faces a framework in which her sum assured is calculated not from her own economic contribution but from her husband’s income. IRDAI permits homemakers to hold term policies with sum assured typically pegged at 50-100 per cent of the earning spouse’s annual income. Her human life value, in the industry’s working model, is a derivative of his.

The Supreme Court has now established that her minimum contribution is ₹30,000 per month, ₹3.6 lakh per year, with legal authority behind it. The insurance framework has no coherent answer for why it should use a different number, or a different person’s number.

The coverage data reinforces the

For the life insurance industry, the SC ruling is an instruction it should act on without waiting for a regulatory directive. A homemaker’s term policy should stand on its own sum assured basis, not as a satellite to her husband’s coverage

urgency. Three in four homemakers carry no critical illness cover. A 2022 Policybazaar survey of 5,000 respondents found that only 15 per cent of active term policies are independent homemaker plans, with most remaining either uninsured or covered only as an add-on to a spouse’s policy. Industry practice recommends term cover of ₹25-50 lakh for homemakers; actual coverage falls far short.

For the life insurance industry, the ruling is an instruction it should act on without waiting for a regulatory directive. Applying the standard Human Life Value methodology, capitalising ₹30,000 per month at six per cent, the accepted long-term safe rate in Indian insurance practice, the defensible term cover for a homemaker works out to ₹60 lakh. As two insurance professionals, we note this is conservative: let’s at least ensure now that a homemaker’s term policy should stand on its own sum assured basis, not as a satellite to her husband’s coverage.

CHANGES NEEDED Three changes follow directly. We should revise homemaker underwriting guidelines to treat ₹30,000 per month as the minimum validated income for Human Life Value computation, independent of the spouse’s earnings, with 10 per cent triennial indexation matching the court’s own mandate. Insurers should rebuild their HLIV calculators on this basis and retrain distribution accordingly. The agent who tells a homemaker she does not need a policy of her own is now working against a Supreme Court ruling.

The ruling also opens a question the court’s framing cannot contain, and it is worth placing on record. The bench limited the homemaker definition to the traditional image of a woman, sociologically honest given how

domestic care is distributed in India. But the principle it constructed rests on the replacement cost of domestic work, not on the gender of the person performing it. A man who manages the household and takes primary caregiving responsibility has an identical replacement cost. The court’s explicit limitation will be tested in litigation.

More pressingly, consider the adult male who does not earn at all: the job-seeker between placements or a young man yet to enter employment. For each of them, a court-validated ₹30,000 floor now exists for a non-earning woman performing domestic work. A MACT tribunal will be asked why an adult male who cooks, cares and maintains a household is valued below that floor.

Whether his non-earning status reflects circumstance, active job search, inadequate wages or family comfort are questions compensation proceedings cannot weigh.

The ruling, rightly focused on ending the undervaluation of women’s domestic labour, has by the force of its own principle opened a far wider debate about how Indian law values any life the market has failed to price, or has priced poorly.

Parliament and IRDAI have clear lanes: align insurance practice with the court’s recognition, extend social protection to caregiving, and examine pension credit for years spent outside the paid workforce. But the larger question the judgment raises belongs to all of us. The court has named the homemaker a nation builder. The financial architecture that surrounds her is yet to respond.

Kumar is former Managing Director of LIC and Sudhakar is former Executive Director of LIC. Views expressed are personal. All data are drawn from publicly available sources

Corporate governance: Lessons from the cricket field

In corporate governance, game awareness is the ability to read situations before they show up in financial statements

SN Ananthasubramanian
MS Sahoo

In cricket, as in life, it is the context which determines the text. A batter may possess flawless technique and impeccable credentials, yet fail if unable to read changing conditions, anticipate risks, and adapt to the demands of the moment. The same is increasingly true in corporate governance. In an era defined by geopolitical volatility, rapid AI integration, activist stakeholders, and shifting regulatory demands, governance requires far more than procedural compliance. It requires the ability to be aware of the game even as it unfolds.

Recent performances on the cricket field offer valuable governance lessons for corporate boards. Take Axar Patel’s pivotal innings for India under immense pressure in Barbados. It didn’t feature the most spectacular, boundary-heavy fireworks of the tournament, but it won the match. Patel quickly assessed a deteriorating situation, absorbed the pressure, rotated strike intelligently, and accelerated only when the conditions allowed.

Corporate boards frequently face identical high-pressure moments, but they often struggle to respond with the same agility. Most governance failures happen in plain sight. Boards today are inundated with presentations, dashboards, compliance checklists, risk

registers, and audit observations. The challenge is rarely a lack of data, but recognising what the data signifies.

Weak signals are dismissed as noise, while emerging risks are underestimated because they don’t fit neatly into quarterly spreadsheets. Cultural deterioration goes unnoticed until it hits the headlines. By the time warning signs become undeniable, the organisation may already be on a downward trajectory.

The early signs of distress are often visible long before the crisis erupts. A sudden increase in employee attrition, recurring customer complaints, persistent regulatory observations, or an unusual concentration of decision-making authority may each appear insignificant in isolation. Viewed together, however, they often reveal vulnerabilities that conventional reporting frameworks fail to capture.

Game awareness in governance is the ability to recognise changing realities before they show up in financial statements. It is the capacity to distinguish signal from noise, identify emerging threats, and understand when ordinary circumstances have become extraordinary. This demands contextual judgment. Just as a seasoned batter reads a slowing pitch or an unexpected field placement, boards must interpret shifting stakeholder expectations, technological disruptions, and organisational sentiment.

Governance is fundamentally about



GOVERNANCE. Cricketing lessons

interpreting context, not just reviewing compliance.

TRUSTING YOUNG TALENT Young Vaibhav Sooryavanshi’s success reflected an institution willing to trust talent regardless of age or seniority. There is an important governance lesson here. Many corporate boards continue to operate within insular cultures where hierarchy is absolute, and length of tenure is valued to the exclusion of fresh perspectives. Yet periods of rapid technological and business transformation often reward cognitive agility, digital fluency, and adaptive thinking as much as experience. Boards that fail to balance seasoned judgment with younger and more diverse perspectives risk strategic stagnation, while those that cultivate emerging leaders are better positioned to navigate uncertainty and change.

Importantly, game awareness is not the responsibility of the captain alone. A cricket team functions because multiple players read the field and respond collectively. Similarly, effective corporate governance cannot depend solely on the chairperson, the CEO, or independent directors. It requires total alignment among boards, executive management, risk officers, and internal auditors.

This has significant implications for governance professionals. Their role can no longer be confined to procedural compliance and administrative stewardship. Governance professionals must become active interpreters of institutional risk, organisational behaviour, and emerging vulnerabilities.

In practice, this requires moving board discussions beyond retrospective reporting to identifying blind spots, emerging risks, and forward-looking scenarios. Compliance remains the baseline, but dynamic awareness sustains resilience.

Compliance is governance’s scoreboard. It tells us what has happened. Game awareness helps us understand what may happen next. Boards that focus only on the scoreboard may remain compliant even as vulnerabilities accumulate beneath the surface.

The writers are former President and former Secretary, respectively, of the Institute of Company Secretaries of India

✉ LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

The magic of football

This refers to the Editorial ‘Game’s on?’ (June 12). For 49 days, starting June 11, under the nimble, dexterous and celebrated feet of players from 48 nations, a round leather object will transform into a magic ball. During its 96 years of history the football World Cup has created gripping incidents like the ‘Hand-of-God’ goal by Diego Maradona and legendary players from Pele to Lamine Yamal now. This Cup will see an enchanting mix of big and small nations together with veteran and young players competing in different playing

conditions being viewed by 7 billion viewers. Sadly, giant India will watch small nations like Croatia playing in the Cup. But will the moment free the country from the clutches of cricket and nurture a game for which it has intrinsic flair?

YG Chouksey
Pune

Apropos ‘Game’s on’, (June 12). For a year, talk about the World Cup focused on politics, visas, climate and a bigger 48-team format. Soon the action on the pitch will take centre stage. So can the old champions from

Europe and South America stay ahead of new challengers? Morocco’s run to the semifinals in Qatar showed the gap is closing. Japan beat Germany and Spain, while Saudi Arabia shocked Argentina. Africa returns stronger with Salah, Mane, and Morocco’s steady core. Messi may play his last Cup, Mbappe leads a deep France, and Spain’s young stars grow fast. K Chidanand Kumar
Bengaluru

Sustainable farming

This refers to the article ‘Right time to focus on sustainable agriculture’

(June 12). Indian agriculture is becoming highly vulnerable to fast changing weathering systems. With predictions of below average monsoon rainfall due to the El Nino induced system, the outlook for agricultural output for FY27 looks bleak. Centre has been taking several steps in insulating agricultural processes and the farmers. Yet, these measures are yet to be scaled up. It is time for Agricultural Extension Offices at all District to take the lead in adopting water conservation technique, crop diversion, extensive usage of organic manure,

pest-resistant newer crop varieties, to boost their agricultural yield.

RV Baskaran
Pune

Petrol woes It refers to ‘Petrol with 22-30% ethanol blend exempted from central excise duty’. It is a welcome move by the government to reduce imports and save forex. Ethanol-blended petrol also helps reduce carbon emissions. A balance between food security and sustainability must be ensured. Bai Govind
Noida



QUICKLY.
ED charges two former executives of ADAG firms

New Delhi: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has filed a prosecution complaint against two former senior executives of Reliance Anil Dhirubhai Ambani Group companies, Amitabh Jhunjhunwala and Amit Bapna, who are among the 55 accused in the ₹12,500 crore bank loan case involving Reliance Home Finance and Reliance Commercial Finance registered by the ED. The prosecution complaint will be presented for consideration before the concerned judge on July 1. **OUR BUREAU**

NLC India bags mineral block in Telangana

New Delhi: State-owned NLC India Ltd said it has secured a critical mineral block in Telangana. In a stock exchange filing, the company said NLC India has been “declared as preferred bidder for critical and strategic mineral block auctions conducted by the Ministry of Mines.” The company said it has been declared the preferred bidder for the Parvathapur vanadium, titanium and aluminous laterite block. **PTI**

NEET review: Disruptors will face full force of law, warns Cabinet Secretary

SECOND ATTEMPT. NTA has announced student-friendly measures for NEET (UG) 2026 to be held on June 21

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Anyone disrupting the NEET re-examination will face ‘full might and weight’ of the law, warned the Cabinet Secretary TV Somnathan on Friday, at a review meeting with the National Testing Agency (NTA) regarding the preparedness for the re-examination.

The re-examination is scheduled to be held on June 21. Meanwhile, NTA also announced a series of student-friendly measures for NEET (UG) 2026 on Friday, including additional rough-work space and an extended examination window.

During the review meeting, Somnathan said that the Central Government, State governments and District administration are working together in close coordination to ensure the smooth conduct of the NEET re-examination. “The full might

and weight of the law will fall on any person trying in any manner to distort, disrupt, or tamper with the integrity or smooth conduct of the re-examination,” he said.

STATE LEVEL. He emphasised the need to ensure a smooth, transparent and secure conduct of the re-examination through close coordination among all concerned stakeholders.

He reviewed the arrangements of the Central government and relevant agencies on June 1.

Subsequently, on June 4, he also held a review meeting with the Chief Secretaries of the State governments to assess the preparedness and progress of the arrangements.

“These meetings are aimed at ensuring effective coordination, strengthening preparedness and maintaining the integrity and credibility of the NEET re-examina-



TEAM WORK. The Centre and the States are working together for the smooth conduct of the NEET re-exam **GRI KVS**

tion process,” an official statement said.

TIME EXTENDED Meanwhile, NTA on Friday said that the examination will be conducted from 2 pm to 5.15 pm, providing a total window of 195 minutes. The duration of the examination has been extended by 15 minutes. “This window is designed to accommodate the invigilation formalities at the start and end of the examination, such as the sign-

ing requirements, which candidates earlier felt reduced their effective working time,” the agency said.

The NTA has also doubled the number of pages provided for rough work in the question paper booklet to four pages, giving candidates additional space for calculations and reasoning. “Candidates may preferably use the rough-work pages provided at the beginning and at the end of the booklet for this purpose,” it said.

Also, the agency has re-designed the placement of rough-work pages to better support left-handed candidates. Earlier, rough-work pages were provided only at the end of the booklet. Under the revised format, two rough-work pages will be placed at the beginning of the booklet, immediately after the instruction page, in addition to those at the end in both English and regional-language versions of the question paper.

“The booklet now offers rough-work space at both the front and the back, allowing every candidate to work comfortably, and it is especially helpful for left-handed candidates, who account for nearly 10 per cent of all candidates,” it said.

The NEET-UG for admissions to medical courses took place on May 3 but was cancelled by the NTA on May 12 amid allegations of a paper leak. The CBI is currently investigating this matter.

VOC Port to invest ₹5,720 crore to deepen harbour, target larger vessels

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The VO Chidambaranar Port Authority in Thoothukudi is up a set to take up a ₹5,720-crore project to deepen its harbour basin and approach channel, to enable handling of larger container, bulk and tanker vessels and strengthen its competitiveness.

The project will increase the port’s draught to 15.2 m from the current 12.8 m. It also includes modification of the port entrance, construc-

tion of six new berths and upgradation of existing berths, according to sources.

Once completed, the enhanced depth will allow the port to handle fully laden Panamax vessels carrying up to 85,000-90,000 tonnes of dry bulk and general cargo, as well as very large container ships with capacities of up to 14,000 TEUs.

LARGER VESSELS The approach channel length will increase from 3.8 km to 10.04 km after the works are completed. Industry sources said the



PORT UPGRADE. The plan also includes modification of the port entrance, construction of six new berths and upgradation of existing berths, according to sources

project has become critical as global shipping lines increasingly deploy larger vessels. At the current draught levels, the port is unable to accommodate container

ships of around 15,000 TEU capacity, they add.

The move is also seen as necessary to remain competitive with nearby transshipment hubs such as Vizhinjam

International Seaport and Colombo, both of which have depths exceeding 15 m.

Vivek Raja of Pearl Shipping in Thoothukudi said that the project will support the growing industrial and export sectors of southern Tamil Nadu.

Given Tamil Nadu’s expanding role in global manufacturing and exports, this project is critical to sustaining long-term economic growth and trade competitiveness, he said.

According to Jaganarayan Padmanabhan, Senior Director & Global

Head- Consulting, Crisil Intelligence, the additional depth will enable the port to attract bigger mainline ships, improve vessel utilisation, lower unit logistics costs and enhance the port’s competitiveness as a gateway for South India, he said.

Given Thoothukudi’s strategic location near the East-West international shipping route, the project can strengthen the port’s ability to attract direct vessel calls, reduce dependence on transshipment hubs and support higher cargo volumes over the long term, he added.

AM Green, VOC Port to develop green ammonia bunkering hub

Our Bureau
Chennai

AM Green, a leading green hydrogen and ammonia developer, in partnership with the VO Chidambaranar Port Authority, Thoothukudi, intends to develop up to 200 ktpa green ammonia marine bunkering capacity by 2029-30 with an estimated investment of ₹2,000 crore.

On May 28, both signed an MoU to this effect, said a release.

The parties also recognise the potential to scale capacity to 500 ktpa by 2035, worth a total investment of ₹5,000 crore, the release said.

The agreement also reinforces AM Green’s commitment to develop a 1 mtpa green ammonia production facility in proximity to the port, worth an investment of

₹15,000 crore, the release said.

LAND ACQUISITION AM Green has already completed a significant portion of the land acquisition for the green hydrogen-ammonia complex, which will also enable ₹35,000 crore investments in renewable energy. Gautam Reddy Kumbam, CEO, AM Green, said VOC port’s existing ammonia infrastructure, its Green Hydrogen Hub designation, and its connectivity to global shipping lanes make this partnership a critical building block in AM Green’s pan-India commercialisation strategy. Susanta Kumar Nath, Chairperson, VOC Port Authority, said, “VOC Port has long been a cornerstone of ammonia supply chain, and this partnership is a natural next step.”

Chhattisgarh gets ₹9,580 crore investment proposals at Hyderabad Investors Connect, to create 7,800 jobs

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Chhattisgarh government received investment proposals worth ₹9,580 crore across sectors spanning data centres, semiconductors and GPU architecture, solar energy equipment, textiles, and pharmaceuticals the State Investors Connect event here on Friday, according to Vishnu Deo Sai, the Chhattisgarh Chief Minister.

Seven major organisations submitted proposals that are expected to generate around 7,800 direct jobs, underscoring growing investor confidence in the State’s industrial ecosystem and policy framework.

The Chief Minister also handed over an “Invitation to invest letter” to prospective investors as part of the State government’s efforts to position the State as a pre-

ferred destination for technology-led and manufacturing investments.

The largest investment proposal came from Hypernext Data Centre, which plans to invest ₹4,200 crore in a modern data centre in Chhattisgarh, expected to generate 250 jobs.

Feegrade and Company had proposed an investment of ₹2,912 crore in the cement sector, with the potential to create around 4,000 jobs; Nivai Labs will invest ₹1,000 crore in the semiconductor and GPU infrastructure sector.

This investment, involving cutting-edge technology, will help integrate the State into the emerging digital and electronics economy and create approximately 200 jobs.

SG Mart, a manufacturer of solar energy equipment, has proposed an investment of ₹700 crore, which is expected to generate about 450



Chhattisgarh CM Vishnu Deo Sai

jobs. Saravana Mills has committed to invest ₹528 crore in the textile industry. This project could create approximately 2,500 jobs. Kabra Drugs and Dinshaw’s Dairy Foods proposed investments of ₹200 crore and ₹40 crore, respectively.

INVESTMENT HUB

Speaking at the Connect, Vishnu Deo Sai said Chhattisgarh was emerging as a

preferred investment destination, supported by “streamlined approvals, a robust single-window system, strong infrastructure and industry-friendly policies.”

Inviting Hyderabad-based companies, particularly in the IT, pharmaceutical and logistics sectors, to invest in the state, the Chief Minister said the State government would extend policy support and a business-friendly environment.

“Hyderabad’s journey from an emerging IT destination to a global technology and innovation hub is inspiring. Chhattisgarh is working on a similar roadmap, and we are already witnessing encouraging results in sectors such as IT, manufacturing and services,” Sai said.

Chhattisgarh was emerging as a leader in green steel production and had so far received investment proposals worth ₹3.5 lakh crore in the energy sector, he added.

Parandur airport project ‘crucial for Tamil Nadu’s \$1.5 trillion economy goal’



(From left) J Krishnan, Partner, S Natesa Iyer Logistics LLP; VK Girish Pandian, President, Industrial Estate Manufacturers Association, Guindy; Vijay Gopalan, former CFO, AirAsia; and K Phanindra Reddy, IAS (retd), at a panel discussion **BUJOY GHOSH**

Our Bureau
Chennai

Tamil Nadu’s goal of becoming a \$1.5-trillion economy by 2036 could face a setback if the proposed greenfield airport at Parandur is delayed, industry leaders and former bureaucrats said here on Friday.

At a panel discussion on ‘The Need for a Second Airport at Parandur’, organised by community platform Super Chennai on Friday, participants argued that the project is no longer merely an aviation initiative but a strategic economic enabler that will determine Tamil Nadu’s ability to attract investments, global capability centres, advanced manufacturing, high-value exports and international business over the coming decades.

CAPACITY AT LIMITS K Phanindra Reddy, a former IAS officer, said infrastructure planning should begin well before facilities reach saturation. He noted that Chennai airport’s expanded capacity is expected to be exhausted by 2028, making the case for a second airport increasingly urgent. J Krishnan, Partner, S Natesa Iyer Logistics LLP, said, “Air cargo accounts for

only about 3 per cent of global trade by volume but nearly 35 per cent by value. As Tamil Nadu focuses on semiconductors, electronics and technology sectors, air cargo will become increasingly important,” he said.

Vijay Gopalan, Chief Financial Officer of Entellus Industries Ltd and former Air-Asia India executive, said Chennai was once India’s third-largest airport and was viewed as a potential aviation hub for Southeast Asia.

“When AirAsia India was launched in 2013, Chennai was our preferred base because of its market potential. Unfortunately, opportunities were lost while competing cities moved ahead with airport expansion and privatisation,” he said.

IT BOOM “We lost opportunities during the IT boom despite starting early. We cannot afford to lose the next wave involving AI, electronics and knowledge industries. Connectivity is a key factor for investors and decision-makers,” he added.

VK Girish Pandian, President of the Industrial Estate Manufacturers Association, noted that many multinational executives prefer Bengaluru due to its superior aviation infrastructure.

Kerala’s Supplyco chalks out revival strategy

Our Bureau
Kochi

Anoop Jacob, Kerala Food and Civil Supplies Minister, has stressed the need for a robust market strategy to revive the Kerala State Civil Supplies Corporation (Supplyco), citing liabilities accumulated over the past decade.

The corporation has been directed to prepare a revival plan focused on diversification and effective utilisation of its extensive retail network to ensure sustainable revenue generation, the Minister told reporters. He pointed out that Supplyco’s total liabilities have crossed ₹3,000 crore, making an urgent turnaround strategy essential.

Jacob blamed the mounting financial burden on the previous LDF government’s decision to keep the prices of 13 subsidised essential com-

modities unchanged during its 10-year tenure from 2016. The resulting losses, he said, began significantly affecting Supplyco’s market intervention capacity from 2022-23 onwards.

REVIVAL EFFORTS Supplyco plans to develop flagship “signature marts” in major districts and launch round-the-clock convenience stores catering to evolving consumer needs. The government is also planning large-scale trade fairs in Thiruvananthapuram, Kochi and Kozhikode ahead of the Onam season, featuring not only subsidised products but also fast-moving consumer goods. Similar fairs will be organised at district and Assembly constituency levels. Strengthening market intervention during the festive season remains the government’s immediate priority, he said.

NITES seeks inquiry into TCS staff death in Pune

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

IT employees union NITES has written to Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis seeking an independent inquiry into the suicide of a Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) employee in Pune. The 48-year-old employee allegedly died following workplace harassment and humiliation by two colleagues, as per a note left behind by the deceased. A criminal case has reportedly been registered against three accused in all, and an investigation is underway, the Nascent Technology Employees Senate (NITES) said.

TCS said in a statement, “We are deeply saddened by the tragic loss of our colleague. Our heartfelt condol-

ences go out to his family and loved ones during this extremely difficult time. The well-being of our employees is of utmost importance to us and we are extending all support to the bereaved family. We have also taken note of the allegations against the two employees and are ascertaining the facts. Complete cooperation is being extended to relevant authorities as they continue their investigation.”

Claiming this as the second employee death connected with the Pune office since January, NITES asked the State government to constitute a high-level independent inquiry committee on the matter. Further, it asked the Labour Commissioner to conduct a special inquiry into workplace practices and employee support systems at TCS.

Bitter season for Kashmir honey, output falls sharply on chill weather, low flowering

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

In the last week of April, when Abid Ali, a beekeeper from the Valley’s sleepy Gangoo village, about 30 km south of Srinagar, returned home with dozens of beehives after spending the entire winter in Rajasthan and Punjab as part of his seasonal migratory beekeeping cycle, he was optimistic about a bumper honey harvest.

However, erratic weather conditions, marked by prolonged rainfall and unusually low temperatures and flowering season, dashed those hopes, leaving him and many other beekeepers in the Valley staring at a sharp decline in production this year.

“I have over 150 colonies



Abid Ali, a beekeeper from the Valley’s Gangoo village

and I could extract only 30 kg of honey, compared to usual 100 kg,” Ali said.

TEMPERATURE DROP The sudden drop in temperatures kept the bees cooped up inside their hives, preventing them from venturing out to collect nectar. Moreover, flowers from acacia trees failed to bloom ad-

equately, resulting in a shortage of nectar for the bees.

“Acacia honey is considered a premium variety in the Valley. This unifloral honey is valued for its light colour, delicate flavour and has high market demand,” said Ali. Apiculture sector scripted a notable success story under the Holistic Agriculture Development Programme (HADP) and the National Beekeeping and Honey Mission. Over the past three years, honey production in Jammu and Kashmir has recorded a sharp rise of over 75 percent. Official data shows that production has increased from around 2,200 tonnes to more than 3,895 tonnes between 2023 to 2025.

ADVERSE WEATHER

This season, however, the

gains of the past few years have been sharply reversed by unfavourable weather conditions that pushed down the temperatures sharply. “Many of us could not even recoup the transport and bee maintenance costs this season due to the low production,” said Nazim Nazir, Chairman of the Valley’s prominent honey producer, Al Nahal Producer Company.

WEATHER CONDITIONS According to Nazir, bees depend largely on either acacia or apple blossoms, but this season erratic weather conditions have adversely affected both flowering cycles.

He added that the unpredictability of seasonal patterns is making migratory beekeeping increasingly difficult to plan and sustain.

Kerala Livestock Development Board Ltd
(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking)
“GOKULAM”, Pattom P.O., Thiruvananthapuram- 695 004,
Kerala, India, Phone: 0471-2440920, 2449138
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KLD Board invites e-tenders under a two-bid system for the supply of Super Insulated Liquid Nitrogen Storage Cryovessels: 3000 L (2 Nos.) and 6000 L (1 No.), and 550 L Bulk Frozen Semen Storage Liquid Nitrogen Refrigerators (2 Nos.)
Last date for online submission: 13/07/2026, 5:00 PM
For further details, log on to www.livestock.kerala.gov.in/www.etenders.kerala.gov.in
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QUICKLY.

Suven to present research posters at US meet

Hyderabad: Suven Life Sciences, a biopharmaceutical company focused on discovering and developing innovative treatments for central nervous system (CNS) disorders, will present three posters at SLEEP-2026, the 40th annual meeting of the Associated Professional Sleep Societies being held at Baltimore, US, during June 14-17. The presentations will showcase the clinical advancement of Samelisant, including positive phase 2 efficacy data in excessive daytime sleepiness, the rationale and design of a phase 2 study for cataplexy in type 1 narcolepsy, and the phase 3 development strategy for Samelisant in patients with narcolepsy. **OUR BUREAU**

Alembic secures FDA approval for Tretinoin

New Delhi: Alembic Pharma on Friday said it has received final approval from US Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for its generic version of Tretinoin cream used in acne treatment. **PTI**

Noida International Airport to handle 40 daily flights by July

TAKING OFF. IndiGo, Akasa Air are launching operations next week; Air India yet to announce plans

Rohit Vaid
Aneesh Phadnis
New Delhi/Mumbai

Noida International Airport (NIA), which begins commercial operations from Monday, will see 40-42 daily flights in the first two months, its senior management told *businessline* in an interview.

While cargo operations too will start from day one, international flights are expected to start later this year with foreign carriers evincing interest to start services to the greenfield airport.

“In June, we will have 12 daily flights, and in July as more destinations get added, we would have around 40-42 flights per day,” said Nitu Samra, the airport’s Chief Executive Officer.

IndiGo and Akasa Air are launching operations from Noida airport next week but



In June, we will have 12 daily flights, and in July, as more destinations get added, we would have around 40-42 flights per day

NITU SAMRA
Chief Executive Officer, NIA



Air India is yet to announce its plans.

“We remain in contact and in discussion with other domestic and international carriers,” said Christoph Schnellmann, Executive Vice-Chairman of the airport’s board.

Noida airport, situated at Jewar, will provide better air connectivity for residents and businesses in western Uttar Pradesh. The first phase, consisting of a single

runway and passenger terminal, has been developed at cost of ₹11,200 crore.

Last month, the Airport Economic Regulatory Authority allowed the Noida airport to collect ₹490 as user development fee (UDF) from domestic departing passengers.

Asked if high UDF would deter passengers from flying from Noida, Samra said the fee is not that high considering it is an greenfield airport.

AAIB continues investigation into Air India crash

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) has said that technical evaluation as well as specialist examination are continuing as part of the ongoing investigation into the Air India AI171 crash.

businessline was the first to report on Thursday, citing sources, that the investigation “is on track” and that it might take another “2-3 months before completion”.

Speaking to *businessline* on Friday, industry insiders



MAJOR HEADWAY. AAIB said that significant progress had been made in analysing evidence gathered during the probe

pointed out that crash investigation reports globally take an average of two and a half years to be completed.

Consequently, the AAIB on Friday issued an interim statement on the first anniversary of the accident,

June 12, 2026, stating that significant progress had been made in analysing evidence gathered during the probe.

The probe agency said that the evidence collected so far, along with the results of vari-

ous examinations, is currently being analysed in a comprehensive and integrated manner.

“Additional technical evaluations and specialist examinations, wherever considered necessary, will continue to be undertaken to ensure that all findings and conclusions are supported by verified evidence and sound scientific analysis,” the bureau said.

The statement comes a year after the Air India flight to London crashed shortly after take-off, resulting in the loss of 260 lives.

According to AAIB, the in-

vestigation team had carried out an extensive examination of technical, operational, organisational and human factors associated with the accident.

SIGNIFICANT PROGRESS Furthermore, the AAIB said significant progress had been made in the examination and analysis of aircraft systems, flight recorder data, engine-related components, maintenance records, operational documentation and other evidence relevant to the investigation.

However, the AAIB maintained that the investigation

was ongoing, and further technical work would continue before the final report is completed.

The bureau reiterated that the final investigation report would be released only after the completion of all investigative activities, as well as the international review and consultation processes prescribed under ICAO Annex 13. The AAIB emphasised that the purpose of an accident investigation is to improve aviation safety through the identification of lessons and safety recommendations, and not to apportion blame or liability.

Air India strengthens internal safety audits following Ahmedabad crash

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Air India has strengthened its internal safety audits going beyond the regulatory requirements, the airline has said.

This change was brought following the Ahmedabad air crash last June that killed 260 people.

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) regulation requires airlines to carry out internal safety audits of various departments like operations, maintenance, ground handling, etc. As per the regulation, audit needs to be carried out once annually at the main base and once in two years at other airports.

Air India said it has taken a rigorous approach and is carrying out internal audits at its Delhi hub twice annually.

Audits at other stations would be carried once every year.

“This reflects a conscious move to exceed regulatory requirements. This broader and more frequent audit regime reinforces oversight, drives continuous improvement, and strengthens operational resilience,” the airline said.

MORE INSPECTIONS

In the aftermath of the crash last June, Air India initiated a voluntary safety pause to carry out additional inspections on its widebody Boeing 777 and Boeing 787 under DGCA supervision.

The additional ground time also helped the airline to work on fleet reliability aimed at reducing technical delays and cancellations.

The focus has been on identifying recurring issues, carrying out component upgrades, and strengthening

More audits reinforce oversight, drive continuous improvement, and strengthen operational resilience

maintenance and spare parts support so that flights operate more smoothly and on schedule. Air India said the scope of reliability enhancement programme for widebody aircraft had expanded over the last year, to identify and address opportunities to improve operational performance across the fleet.

While there are improvements, Air India’s record in safety is still below par.

In its March report, a parliamentary panel highlighted details of DGCA audit that

found recurring defects in 377 of 754 commercial aircraft in India. The audit was carried out between January 2025 and February 2026.

In the case of Air India, 137 of its 166 aircraft showed repeated defects while 54 of Air India Express’s 101 planes had persistent technical issues.

“Safety is not a priority for Air India despite the AI 171 accident last June. One would have hoped for greater accountability from the top leadership but that has not happened,” said Captain Mohan Ranganathan, an aviation safety expert.

“Post Ahmedabad crash, there have been many safety-related incidents like pilots flying without valid licences. Crew fatigue is also an area of concern. It seems the airline is prioritising commercial considerations over safety,” he alleged.

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

On the first anniversary of the Air India plane crash that claimed 260 lives in Ahmedabad, the Gujarat government on Friday announced plans to redevelop the disaster-affected New Mental Campus in Meghanagar into a major health and medical education hub, with projects worth more than ₹547 crore.

Paying tribute to those who lost their lives in the June 12, 2025 tragedy, Gujarat Health Minister Praful Pansheriya said the State has decided to transform the site of the disaster into a centre for healthcare, rehabilitation, research and medical education.

This will be done by removing the fully and partially damaged and charred



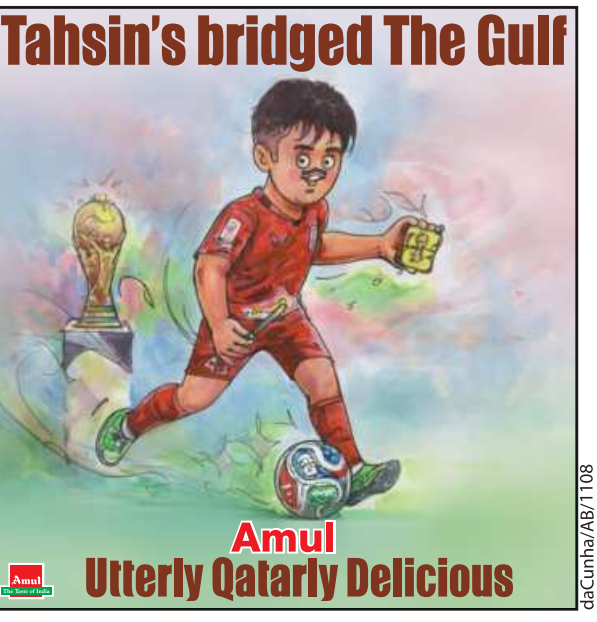
HEALTHCARE HOTSPOT. Once completed, the New Mental Campus is expected to emerge as one of Gujarat’s leading centres for health services and rehabilitation **PTI**

buildings on the campus, where the aircraft crash landed a year ago.

The Minister said the government had drawn up a long-term redevelopment plan for the campus.

LARGEST PROJECT

The largest project under the plan is a ₹295-crore Paraplegia and Spine Hospital, along with a rehabilitation centre, physiotherapy college and



Singapore court stays order against Byju Raveendran

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



Byju Raveendran

Embattled edtech Byju’s founder Byju Raveendran has secured temporary relief from a Singapore court after the General Division of the High Court of Singapore granted a stay on the committal and surrender provisions of its civil contempt order issued on May 25.

The stay, granted on June 10, means that Raveendran is not required to surrender to the authorities, and no term of imprisonment will take effect while his appeal is being heard. The development comes amid an ongoing legal battle linked to the edtech company’s disputed \$1.2 billion term loan and related arbitration proceedings.

ORDER CHALLENGED

Raveendran had also filed an appeal against the contempt finding, arguing that the underlying orders and disclosure obligations remain contested and are themselves subject to separate proceedings seeking to set them aside. “There was an abso-

lutely incorrect public narrative created post the selective verbal leak of the earlier order by the Singapore court falsely claiming an arrest warrant had been issued against Raveendran,” said J Michael McNutt, Senior Litigation Advisor to Raveendran and the founders at Lazareff Le Bars.

Raveendran said he remains committed to contesting what he described as a misleading narrative surrounding the case.

“I welcome the stay granted by the Singapore court. At a time when parties have been engaged in settlement discussions, it is unfortunate that a misleading impression of wrongdoing is being created,” he said.

A daughter’s final selfie, unanswered questions and a year of grief as kin of Air India crash reunite

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Suresh Mistry held on tightly to the last photograph his daughter ever clicked. The selfie, taken by 24-year-old Kinal Mistry at Ahmedabad airport moments before she boarded Air India flight AI-171 on June 12 last year, captured a young woman about to begin a journey.

Hours later, she was among the 260 people killed in one of India’s deadliest aviation disasters.

On Friday, as families of victims gathered in Ahmedabad to mark the first anniversary of the crash, Mistry carried the photograph with him. Around him sat nearly 150 families connected by a shared tragedy.

Some carried framed portraits. Others brought files containing compensation claims, correspondence with authorities and requests for missing belongings. Almost all carried questions that re-

mained unanswered a year later.

“Had the government organised a memorial service and met the families of the victims, it would have been heartening for us,” Mistry said.

REMEMBRANCE EVENT

The gathering, organised by Chionuma Law Firm and Beasley Allen Law Firm, became more than a remembrance event. It evolved into a forum where grieving families spoke of delayed investigations, unrecovered possessions, compensation disputes and what many described as an absence of official recognition of their loss.

For Mistry, the anniversary was particularly difficult. Kinal had travelled to India for a month and was preparing to return after undergoing a dental procedure. Instead, her family members found themselves marking her first death anniversary. “Today we had a ceremony back at our home in Anand,



SHARING SORROW. Family members of the victims of the crash attend ‘A Day of Remembrance’ on Friday, marking the first anniversary of the tragedy in Ahmedabad **ANI**

but I decided to travel here for this get-together,” he said.

The search for answers was a recurring theme through the afternoon. Prakash Chaudhary, who travelled from Dhanera in Banaskantha district, lost his younger sister Dhapuben and her husband Kamlesh in the crash. The couple had been married barely five months. Their trip aboard AI-171 was meant to be their

first journey abroad together.

“My youngest sister and her husband were on the flight,” Chaudhary said. “It’s been a year since the crash happened and the government is yet to find out what caused the crash.”

UNCERTAINTY PREVAILS

For many families, the passage of time has only deepened their frustration. While anniversaries are ex-

pected to bring closure, several attendees said the absence of a final report has prolonged uncertainty. Others spoke of a different kind of anguish — the inability to recover the belongings their loved ones carried on board.

Eighteen-year-old Vihar Parikh flew in from London with his father to attend the gathering in memory of his grandfather, who died in the crash. The family is still waiting for the return of his grandfather’s mobile phone and personal documents.

“We are yet to receive the mobile phone and the documents that my grandfather was carrying,” Parikh said.

“Photographs of these recovered documents and passports were sent to us.” What has troubled the family further is evidence suggesting the phone may have been active months after the crash.

“The Google activity also showed that my grandfather’s phone had become active on March 15, 2026. Des-

pite us mailing Air India to recover the belongings, there has been no response from the airline,” he said.

DAMAGED BAGGAGE

Parikh said the experience has affected the family’s confidence in the airline. During their journey to Ahmedabad for the anniversary event, he and his father encountered flight delays and damaged baggage.

“All I want to ask is, will anything improve in the near future?” he said.

Questions over documentation and identification procedures also surfaced during the gathering. Kinal Patel from Vasad lost her mother, who was travelling abroad for the first time to visit her son. A year later, she says several aspects of the official records continue to puzzle the family.

“My mother who was travelling for the first time on the flight to meet my brother was killed,” Patel said. “Today I just want to say that

the government should come out with the report on the crash as soon as possible.”

She pointed to inconsistencies she believes remain unexplained. “My mother’s *panchmama* clearly says that her DNA test was conducted using the victim’s blood. But the documents also say that the body was burnt. There have been unanswered questions.”

The struggles described by families were not limited to grief and unanswered queries.

MENTALLY HARASSED

Dipak Manariya, who travelled from Udaipur, said life after the tragedy brought fresh challenges. After losing his father in the crash, he accepted a job offered through the Tata Trust. “After my father passed away in the crash, the Tata Trust gave me a job. I joined in January 2026 and thereafter I was mentally harassed,” Manariya alleged. He said repeated requests

to be stationed closer to home were denied.

“Despite my request to be stationed in Udaipur, I was asked to visit far-flung places like Dungarpur and Banswara. After three months, I quit the job,” he said.

Even now, he added, some of his father’s belongings remain missing despite repeated emails to both Air India and the Tata Trust. Allegations made by the families against Air India could not be independently verified.

Not all those remembered at the gathering had been passengers on the aircraft. Among those attending was Nilesh Setha, whose brother and sister — both doctors — died when the aircraft crashed into the Atulyam hostel complex. They were on the ground when disaster struck.

“My only request to the government is to build a memorial at the crash site in memory of all those who died,” Setha said.

